

英検準2級

過去問

長文問題集

収録内容

2007年度第3回～2017年度第3回

[B]

A Better Way to Relax

Going to the hospital for an operation is frightening for most adults, and it can be even more stressful for children. Research shows that children who suffer from stress in this way take a longer time to recover after an operation. Because of this, hospital staff members try to make the day of the operation as (36) as possible for children. They decorate waiting areas with colorful posters and play relaxing music. Doctors also sometimes give children drugs a few hours before an operation to make them feel calm. However, some doctors have recently been trying an unusual way to relax children before an operation — letting them play handheld video games.

In 2004, Dr. Anuradha Patel from The University Hospital, in New Jersey, tried to find out how well this method worked. She decided to do her research after watching a boy playing a video game at a restaurant. He was so interested in the game that he did not seem to notice what was happening around him. Dr. Patel thought that the (37) thing might be true for children who played video games before an operation.

To test her idea, Dr. Patel studied three groups of children. Children in the first group were given a drug to relax them before their operation. Those in the second group played a video game instead of receiving the drug. Those in the third group neither took a drug nor played a game. When Dr. Patel and her team of researchers measured the stress levels of the children, they found that the second group had the lowest levels. As a result, Dr. Patel felt sure that having children play video games was the best way to stop them from (38) about an operation.

- | | | | |
|------------------|------------|------------|--------------|
| (36) 1 necessary | 2 pleasant | 3 fast | 4 honest |
| (37) 1 worst | 2 deep | 3 fresh | 4 same |
| (38) 1 reading | 2 calling | 3 worrying | 4 forgetting |

[B]

A Home Away from Home

Taking your family on an overseas vacation can be very expensive. In addition to air tickets, you usually have to pay for hotel rooms, restaurant meals, and local transportation. One way to save money on an overseas vacation is to do a home exchange. On a home exchange, you go on a vacation and stay in another family's home while they stay in yours. Both families get a place to stay for free, and they often use each other's cars and look after each other's pets. Over the last 20 years, home-exchange vacations have become more and more popular, and now about 60,000 families take one every year.

Most of these vacations are arranged through home-exchange websites like ExchangeHomes.com. This site has information from thousands of people who want to do home exchanges. After paying a small amount of money to join, new members can describe their homes and say where they want to go on vacation. They can also contact other members on the site.

Some people are afraid that their things might be stolen or broken if they let strangers stay in their home. However, Anne Pottinger, the owner of ExchangeHomes.com, believes that such problems are rare. She says that she has never had reports of home exchangers damaging things on purpose or stealing things. In any case, she adds, it is safer to have people stay in your home during a vacation than to leave it empty.

Naturally, many people want to stay in homes in places that are popular with tourists, such as Paris or New York. However, others are interested in a more unusual vacation experience. Sheila Shockey, for example, who lives in a small town in Kansas, in the United States, has been asked to exchange her home by people who live in Hawaii and Australia. These families enjoy experiencing everyday life in small, ordinary towns.

(42) What has become popular with some families?

- 1 Staying at hotels that are run by families.
- 2 Exchanging family members for a short time.
- 3 Sharing the cost of air tickets with other families.
- 4 Using another family's home during their vacation.

(43) What can families do by using ExchangeHomes.com?

- 1 Contact people who live in places they want to visit.
- 2 Find information about the best home-exchange websites.
- 3 Sell their homes to the people who will pay the most money.
- 4 Make money by having people stay in their homes.

(44) According to Anne Pottinger,

- 1 home exchangers can quickly find information about cities to visit.
- 2 families can keep their homes safer by doing a home exchange.
- 3 home exchangers sometimes steal things from others' homes.
- 4 most families who use her website send her reports.

(45) Sheila Shockey's experience shows that some people who do home exchanges

- 1 find jobs at local companies during their vacations.
- 2 think about moving to a new city after their vacation.
- 3 want to go to places that are not popular with tourists.
- 4 trade homes with people who did not advertise on a website.

[B]

Green Weddings

When couples get married, they want their wedding to be an event that their friends and families will always remember. Because of this, they spend a lot of time preparing for it. In addition to the wedding ceremony, couples often organize a large party afterward at a hotel or restaurant. Recently, many couples in the United States have also been paying attention to the effect that their wedding might have on the environment. (36), more and more couples are choosing to have environmentally friendly “green” weddings.

One way to make a wedding more environmentally friendly is to reduce waste. For example, guests at American weddings traditionally bring a gift, but some couples now ask their guests to give money to a charity instead. This not only helps the charity but also means that the couples do not (37) items that they may not want. Another idea is to use flowers that have been grown locally. This is better for the environment than transporting flowers from far away, which uses a lot of fuel. Also, instead of buying a new wedding dress that will probably not be used again, some brides wear their mother’s wedding dress or buy a secondhand one.

Green weddings may not be right for everybody. For one thing, a green wedding is not necessarily (38) than a regular one. In fact, some environmentally friendly products are very expensive. Moreover, not all brides like the idea of wearing secondhand dresses. However, making just a few green choices when planning a wedding can be good news for the environment.

- | | | |
|--------------------------|---------------|----------------------|
| (36) 1 On the other hand | 2 By mistake | |
| 3 As a result | 4 Sadly | |
| (37) 1 receive | 2 order | 3 borrow 4 lose |
| (38) 1 quieter | 2 cheaper | |
| 3 more important | 4 more useful | |

Cycle City

The streets of Paris are often crowded with cars and other vehicles. This traffic makes it difficult to travel around the city and also causes pollution. In July 2007, the city government introduced a system to help solve these problems. It parked about 10,000 bicycles at 750 special bicycle stations around the city. People can rent the bicycles and then return them to any of the stations. The city hopes that people will stop using their cars so much and start riding bicycles more often.

This is not the first time that this type of system has been tried. In Amsterdam in the 1960s, hundreds of bicycles were put on the streets for anyone to use for free. Unfortunately, many of the bicycles were damaged or stolen, and the system had to be stopped.

The city government of Paris is trying to avoid these problems. The bicycles it is using are strong and do not get damaged easily. Also, people must pay a fee by credit card to use the bicycles. The fee is low for the first hour so that people will return the bicycles quickly. But if the bicycle is not returned within 24 hours, 150 euros will be taken from their credit card.

Although the bicycles are already being widely used, it is too soon to tell what effect they are having on the environment. The people who rent the bicycles may not be people who have stopped driving cars. In addition, it is not always possible for drivers to start riding bicycles. People who travel long distances or need extra space because they do a lot of shopping still use cars. However, the Paris bicycle system has been getting a lot of attention around the world, and other cities are thinking about copying it.

- (42) One reason why the bicycle system in Paris was introduced was to
- 1 increase the sale of bicycles.
 - 2 reduce traffic on the streets.
 - 3 make it easier for people to park their bicycles.
 - 4 teach people that they need exercise.
- (43) What is one reason the bicycle system in Amsterdam did not work?
- 1 The bicycles cost too much to rent.
 - 2 People preferred to use their friends' bicycles.
 - 3 The streets were dangerous to ride bicycles on.
 - 4 Many of the bicycles were never returned.
- (44) How can people use a bicycle in Paris for a low fee?
- 1 By paying the bicycle fee in cash.
 - 2 By parking the bicycle at their home.
 - 3 By repairing the bicycle before returning it.
 - 4 By using the bicycle for a short time.
- (45) Why are some people not using the bicycle system?
- 1 They have too many things to carry.
 - 2 They do not like the design of the bicycles.
 - 3 They cannot understand how the system works.
 - 4 They have to park the bicycles too far from stores.

[B]

Sleeping at the Museum

Every month, millions of children in the United States go to museums with their families or on school trips. Although children can learn many things at museums, these visits are not always enjoyable. Famous museums in places like New York City and Washington, D.C., are often crowded with people. As a result, it can be difficult to spend enough time looking at the exhibits and reading the explanations. Also, some museums have few activities for young visitors. Because of this, children can sometimes become (36) there. But recently, many museums have found a new way to get more young visitors. They have been letting them stay overnight.

The American Museum of Natural History in New York City is one museum that has been offering “sleepovers.” These events are for children aged from 8 to 12 and their parents. The cost is \$129 per person, which includes an evening snack and breakfast. But visitors must (37) their own sleeping bags from home. In the evening, the children take a tour of the dinosaur section. The lights of the museum are turned down, and the children are given flashlights to help them see the exhibits. At bedtime, they lay out their sleeping bags under a huge model of a blue whale.

Sleepovers at museums have become popular because they give children a very (38) experience. Few people have the chance to walk around a museum at night, when it is almost empty. Children who have stayed overnight at a museum say that it is very exciting. The museums hope that children who take part in the sleepovers will come back again and again.

- | | | | | |
|------|---------------|-----------|-------------|-------------|
| (36) | 1 bored | 2 smart | 3 pleased | 4 important |
| (37) | 1 hide | 2 sell | 3 bring | 4 wash |
| (38) | 1 traditional | 2 unusual | 3 unhealthy | 4 dangerous |

[B]

The Jeepney

In 1945, at the end of World War II, many soldiers from the U.S. Army returned home from the Philippines. But they left behind hundreds of Jeeps that they had used. These Jeeps were sold or given away to local people. The public-transportation systems in Manila and other large cities had been almost completely destroyed during the war, so the new owners of these vehicles decided to use them as shared taxis.

Shared taxis are a popular type of transport in many countries around the world. In some ways, they are actually more like buses than taxis. For example, shared taxis often follow the same route every day. But they are more convenient than buses because passengers can get on or off anywhere along the route.

It was necessary to make several changes to the U.S. Army Jeeps before they could be used as shared taxis. The new owners made the Jeeps longer and put more seats in the back. Because the Jeeps had no roofs, the owners added them to protect passengers from the sun and the rain. Then, in order to attract passengers, the owners painted the sides of the Jeeps with bright colors and added flags, mirrors, and other decorations.

The result was a colorful vehicle that looked like a small bus and carried about 15 people. People in the Philippines called them “jeepneys.” These vehicles were very tough, so they could be driven on rough roads in the countryside. Because it was expensive to buy a new vehicle, jeepney owners were careful to keep them in good condition. In fact, some of the original jeepneys are still being used today. For many people in the Philippines, jeepneys are not only a convenient way of getting around but also a symbol of how the Philippines was able to recover from the war.

- (42) In Manila at the end of World War II,
- 1 there was very little public transportation.
 - 2 the U.S. Army destroyed their own Jeeps.
 - 3 local people sent their vehicles to America.
 - 4 American soldiers started driving shared taxis.
- (43) What is one advantage of shared taxis?
- 1 They go faster than most buses.
 - 2 They take people to other countries.
 - 3 Passengers can get off at any time.
 - 4 Passengers can change the routes.
- (44) The new owners of the Jeeps
- 1 removed seats from the back.
 - 2 added roofs to protect passengers.
 - 3 made them look like army vehicles.
 - 4 used them to sell flags and other decorations.
- (45) Which of the following statements is true?
- 1 The original jeepneys can no longer be seen.
 - 2 Owners of jeepneys took good care of their vehicles.
 - 3 People in the Philippines can ride jeepneys for free.
 - 4 Jeepneys are shorter than U.S. Army Jeeps.

[B]

Camping in Style

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There are many beautiful places in North America to go camping. Camping is popular because it is a great way to spend time surrounded by nature. However, some people (36) certain things about camping. For example, they would prefer not to have to put up a tent, cook for themselves, or sleep on the ground in a sleeping bag. But now, a small number of campgrounds are offering camping vacations where people do not need to do any of these things. This type of camping is sometimes called “glamorous camping” because it is a little like staying at a five-star hotel.

One campground that offers glamorous-camping vacations is The Resort at Paws Up in Montana in the United States. Here, guests sleep in large tents that have beds, rugs, and heaters. Near each tent, there is a private bathroom. Guests do not have to do any of the work that campers do on a (37) camping vacation. For example, a staff member builds a campfire, and an expert chef cooks each meal. There is also a maid to make the beds and clean up the tent.

Of course, glamorous camping is very expensive. At a campground on Vancouver Island in Canada, guests pay as much as \$10,000 per week. Some people think that guests at these campgrounds do not (38) the real fun of camping. They say that doing things like cooking food over a fire is what makes camping enjoyable. However, glamorous camping may be a good choice for people who want to camp in comfort — and who do not mind paying for it.

- | | | | |
|--------------|----------|--------------|-----------|
| (36) 1 hide | 2 miss | 3 follow | 4 dislike |
| (37) 1 safe | 2 normal | 3 secret | 4 lonely |
| (38) 1 avoid | 2 forget | 3 experience | 4 save |

[B]

Potato Power

The United Nations (UN) made 2008 the International Year of the Potato. This may sound like a strange idea, but the UN had a serious aim. The aim was to tell people around the world about the good points of potatoes. The UN wanted people to know that potatoes are not only very good for you but also easy to grow.

Of course, people in some parts of the world have been eating potatoes for a long time. In fact, the first potatoes were grown more than 8,000 years ago by the Inca people of Peru. Later, in the 16th century, potatoes were taken to Europe, and they quickly became a common European food. Europeans still eat more potatoes than anyone else. However, people in Asia and Africa now eat twice as many potatoes as they did 40 years ago.

The reason why the UN decided to have a special year for potatoes is that they have many advantages over other foods that people grow. Potatoes need very little water and can grow in as few as 50 days. Moreover, they do not need much land to grow. They also grow well in both hot and cold countries. Recently, there has been a shortage of many foods, such as wheat and rice. One reason for this is that the world's population is increasing. The UN says that in order to feed everyone in the future, we need to grow more potatoes.

Many people agree with this idea. China, which is already the largest producer of potatoes in the world, plans to grow even more of the crop in the future. Also, India is trying to develop a new kind of fast-growing potato. In the future, it seems likely that the potato will be an important vegetable that people all over the world eat every day.

- (42) Why did the United Nations create the International Year of the Potato?
- 1 To look for strange new vegetables.
 - 2 To teach people different ways to cook potatoes.
 - 3 To tell people about the advantages of potatoes.
 - 4 To hold a special food festival for farmers.
- (43) What has changed over the past 40 years?
- 1 Farms around the world can now grow bigger potatoes.
 - 2 People in Asia and Africa now eat more potatoes than before.
 - 3 New kinds of potatoes have been discovered in South America.
 - 4 Europeans have started buying potatoes from Peru.
- (44) What is one advantage of potatoes?
- 1 They can be sent to other countries quickly.
 - 2 They can be left in the fields for a long time.
 - 3 They can be planted together with other crops.
 - 4 They can be grown without much water.
- (45) In the future,
- 1 people everywhere are likely to eat potatoes regularly.
 - 2 India will buy most of its potatoes from other countries.
 - 3 the UN could start selling potatoes all around the world.
 - 4 China will develop new fast-growing potatoes.

Junior Cooks

Many Americans are worried about the number of children in the United States who are overweight. A recent study showed that 19 percent of children between the ages of 6 and 11 weigh too much. One reason for this is that some parents give their children convenience foods or take them to eat at fast-food restaurants. Another is that when children buy food and drinks, they often choose unhealthy items. (36), many children prefer sweet drinks like cola to healthier drinks like milk.

Some people think that the answer to this problem is to teach children to cook. They say that when children become interested in cooking, they begin to want to eat (37) food. They ask their parents for healthier meals and buy fewer candies and soft drinks. In 2006, an organization called the Junior League started a new program. In this program, the Junior League invites children to meetings where cooks explain how to prepare healthy snacks and meals.

Cookbooks for children are also becoming more popular. In the past, children's cookbooks were often boring because they only introduced very (38) meals. Recently, though, these cookbooks have become much more interesting. They have many dishes that are more difficult to make, and they also have information about healthy eating. Some teach children how to make food from other parts of the world, such as sushi rolls from Japan and *bibimbap* from Korea. In this way, they show children that eating healthily is not only good for you, but also fun.

- | | | |
|------|-------------|---------------------|
| (36) | 1 Luckily | 2 For example |
| | 3 Even then | 4 On the other hand |
| (37) | 1 quicker | 2 cheaper |
| | 3 better | 4 colder |
| (38) | 1 simple | 2 exciting |
| | 3 secret | 4 heavy |

Mary Anning

At the beginning of the 19th century, people's ideas about the natural world were different from those that are common today. Most people in Europe did not believe that animal species died out. When the remains of unknown animals were found, it was thought that the animals must be living somewhere in the world. By the end of the century, however, people understood that the Earth had once been full of dinosaurs and other strange animals. An important reason for this change was the discovery of many dinosaur fossils. One person who played a big part in these discoveries was Mary Anning.

Mary was born in 1799 in Lyme Regis, a small port in the south of England. The seashore at Lyme Regis has many fossils in its rocks. Mary's father, Richard Anning, was a carpenter, but he also collected fossils and sold them to visitors. He taught Mary and her brother, Joseph, how to find fossils and sell them.

Richard died in 1810, and Mary's family became very poor. They continued hunting for fossils to make some money. Then, when Mary was 12 years old, she and her brother made a great discovery. This was the complete fossil of a strange creature with teeth like a crocodile's and a body like a dolphin's. Many scientists went to see the fossil. An expert at the British Museum named the animal an "ichthyosaur," which means "fish lizard."

Mary began to buy books so that she could learn more about dinosaurs. Later, she made many more important discoveries. However, although she knew more about fossils than most professors, she did not become famous until the end of her life. This was because she was poor and because she was a woman. A few months before she died in 1847, though, she was honored by the government, and since then she has been known as one of the first experts in the study of dinosaurs.

- (42) The discovery of dinosaur fossils in the 19th century
- 1 helped people find dinosaurs living in Europe.
 - 2 made it seem unlikely that animals could die out.
 - 3 changed people's ideas about the natural world.
 - 4 caused people to believe in animals that never existed.

- (43) What is one thing Mary Anning learned from her father?
- 1 How to collect fossils from the seashore.
 - 2 How to paint pictures on rocks.
 - 3 The names of the fossils he found.
 - 4 The history of the port of Lyme Regis.

- (44) When Mary Anning was 12 years old, she and her brother
- 1 started to visit the British Museum.
 - 2 met a scientist who gave them a job.
 - 3 saw a strange animal in the sea.
 - 4 found a very important fossil.

- (45) Which of the following statements about Mary Anning is true?
- 1 She became a famous university professor.
 - 2 She was not well known for most of her lifetime.
 - 3 She worked for the government at the end of her life.
 - 4 She was not able to sell the fossils she found.

Lighthouse Homes

One way that sailors keep their ships safe at sea is to look for lighthouses. These are tall towers with a bright light at the top that warn ships not to come too close to dangerous parts of the coast. Lighthouses are also useful because they show sailors which part of the coast they are near. These days, however, most ships have electronic tools for navigation. As a result, lighthouses are less (**36**) than they were in the past.

Many lighthouses in the United States were built more than 100 years ago. These lighthouses used oil lamps for their lights. Each lighthouse had a lighthouse keeper. The keeper's job was to light the oil lamp every evening, make sure that it kept burning all night, and put it out at sunrise. Because of this, older lighthouses usually have places where lighthouse keepers and their families could (**37**).

In recent years, the United States government has started selling some of its older lighthouses. At first, only certain groups could buy these lighthouses. But since 2000, ordinary people have been allowed to buy them, too. Many people are interested in owning a lighthouse because they like the idea of having a home that is surrounded by nature and has wonderful views. However, people who buy lighthouses from the government have to show that they will (**38**) them properly. They must paint the walls regularly and be careful not to change the way the lighthouse looks when they do repairs. This is because many lighthouses are important historical buildings that add to the beauty of America's coastlines.

- | | | | | |
|-------------|---------------|---------------|--------------|------------|
| (36) | 1 necessary | 2 comfortable | 3 shocking | 4 peaceful |
| (37) | 1 shop | 2 call | 3 travel | 4 live |
| (38) | 1 walk around | 2 write about | 3 look after | 4 ask for |

The Muppet Maker

Most people in the United States are familiar with the puppets that Jim Henson created for his TV shows. Henson got his first part-time job in 1954, while he was still a high school student. He worked for a TV station in Washington, D.C., making puppets for a children's show. Henson had been making puppets as a hobby since he was a child, so he was happy to get this job.

Later, when Henson was in college, he worked on another children's show called *Sam and Friends*. The puppets that Henson created for *Sam and Friends* were different from the ones that were usually seen on television at that time. Most puppets on television were made of wood, but Henson used materials like rubber and cloth to make his. Because these materials are soft, the puppets that Henson created could be used to show a lot of different feelings. He called these puppets "Muppets."

After Henson graduated from college, he continued to make Muppets for TV shows and commercials. Then, in 1969, he was asked to work on a new show called *Sesame Street* that taught English, math, and everyday skills to young children. The Muppets sang, danced, and had conversations with the actors. The show was very successful, and the Muppets became famous all over the United States.

Henson enjoyed working on *Sesame Street*, but he wanted to create shows that would be watched by people of all ages. He achieved this in 1976, when he started a family variety show called *The Muppet Show*. By 1978, it had over 235 million viewers in 106 countries. Henson also made many other shows and several movies. Jim Henson died in 1990, but he will always be remembered for his Muppets, which are loved by both children and adults around the world.

(42) Before Jim Henson started working at a TV station in Washington, D.C.,

- 1 he created many TV shows.
- 2 he made puppets in his free time.
- 3 a local high school offered him a job.
- 4 most people knew who he was.

(43) How were Henson's Muppets different from most puppets used on television?

- 1 They could move without the help of people.
- 2 They had names chosen by television viewers.
- 3 They were made of a different type of wood.
- 4 They were created from soft materials.

(44) How did the Muppets become famous all over the United States?

- 1 Henson took them to schools to teach children.
- 2 They were used instead of actors in commercials.
- 3 They appeared on a TV show for children.
- 4 Henson wrote a song about them.

(45) What was Henson able to do in 1976?

- 1 Teach young children how to make their own puppets.
- 2 Start a show that could be enjoyed by adults and children.
- 3 Build a school with the money he made from *Sesame Street*.
- 4 Make a movie using actors from many different countries.

Pets at Work

Many people love to spend time with their pets, but in the past, few people thought of taking their pets to work. However, in 1999, an organization called Pet Sitters International started an event called “Take Your Dog to Work Day.” By June 2008, over 10,000 companies in the United States, Canada, and Britain were taking part in the event. In addition, a growing number of companies have started to let their employees bring pets on other days of the year, too.

Of course, having pets in the workplace can lead to (36). For example, having pets in factories might be dangerous because they could cause accidents. Noisy animals, such as some birds, could make it hard for people in offices to concentrate on their work. Moreover, some people have allergies or are frightened of certain animals. Because of these possible difficulties, companies usually try to get the agreement of all their employees before they (37) their rules.

Supporters of pet-friendly policies point out that there are several advantages to having pets in the workplace. John S. Long III, from Pet Sitters International, says that people feel less stressed and work better with pets around. Pets can also improve (38) in an office. This is because people are more likely to talk to co-workers who have a dog or other pet with them. In addition, pet owners can stay at work longer when they need to because they do not have to go home to take care of their pets. In the future, even more companies may open their doors to pets.

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|------|-----------------|--------------|------------------|----------|
| (36) | 1 memories | 2 friendship | 3 problems | 4 waste |
| (37) | 1 copy | 2 read | 3 sell | 4 change |
| (38) | 1 communication | | 2 transportation | |
| | 3 luck | | 4 pay | |

The Edinburgh Festival Fringe

Edinburgh, the capital city of Scotland, is famous for its festivals. The city's largest festival, called the Edinburgh Festival Fringe, is held in August every year. It is the largest arts festival in the world. There are many types of performances at the Edinburgh Festival Fringe, such as comedy, theater, music, and dance. In 2008, there were over 2,000 different shows.

The Edinburgh Festival Fringe began in the summer of 1947, when the city was holding an arts festival called the Edinburgh International Festival. The organizers of the Edinburgh International Festival had invited artists to perform at some of the city's theaters. However, some groups of artists who had not been invited also went to the city, and they performed their shows in other theaters. The same thing happened at the International Festival in the following years, and these shows at other theaters became known as the Fringe.

One unusual thing about the Fringe is that performers can do any type of show they choose. They just have to pay some money to the Fringe's organizers. As a result, there are always a lot of strange and interesting shows at the Fringe. However, some people say that the quality of many of the shows is poor.

Although performers at the Fringe sell tickets for their shows, many of them lose money. This is because they must pay for advertising and a place to perform, as well as give money to the organizers. But if their shows are popular, they can become better known and get the chance to do their shows in other places. Many actors and comedians who have performed at the Fringe have later appeared in movies and on television. This is one reason why it seems likely that the Fringe will continue to grow.

(42) What happens in Edinburgh every August?

- 1** A concert is given by 2,000 people.
- 2** Scotland's largest food festival is held.
- 3** Comedians, musicians, and dancers perform.
- 4** People come to see the city's famous castle.

(43) What happened at the Edinburgh International Festival in 1947?

- 1** Some people who were not invited came to do shows.
- 2** Many people asked to change the name of the festival.
- 3** All of the festival's tickets sold out on the first day.
- 4** People started to visit shows in other cities.

(44) What do some people say about the Fringe?

- 1** Many performers do the same show every year.
- 2** Many of the shows are not very good.
- 3** It costs a lot of money to see.
- 4** It is becoming less popular every year.

(45) Many performers want to join the Fringe because

- 1** it is a way to meet other performers.
- 2** it is sometimes shown on television.
- 3** it is free to perform there.
- 4** it is a chance to become famous.

A Little Good News

When we watch the news on TV, we usually hear about such things as wars, accidents, and crimes. While it is important to know about these things, many people would like to hear more good news. An American woman named Geri Weis-Corbley decided in 1997 that more happy news should be (36). Since that year, she has been running the *Good News Network* website, which offers good news from around the world.

Weis-Corbley used to work for a TV company, filming and writing news stories. Based on her experience, she thought that most people would like to hear more good news. Every day, she searches the Internet for happy stories. She then puts them on her website. In September 2008, there was a lot of bad news. Several large American banks got into trouble, and many companies had to go out of business. Because of these (37), visitors to the *Good News Network* increased. This shows that when most news is bad, there are many people who want to see some good news instead.

Weis-Corbley believes that the media should be more (38). For example, when a small number of people do something bad, it is always in the news. She argues that we need to have good news as well as bad news so we can think about the good things in life. Tal Ben-Shahar, a professor of psychology at Harvard University, has a similar opinion. He says that only hearing bad news makes people see everything in a negative way. Sometimes, hearing good news can help us to have a more positive point of view.

- | | | | | |
|------|-------------|------------|-------------|----------------|
| (36) | 1 reported | 2 invented | 3 corrected | 4 blocked |
| (37) | 1 replies | 2 secrets | 3 promises | 4 difficulties |
| (38) | 1 expensive | 2 balanced | 3 serious | 4 dramatic |

Camels in Australia

When people think of animals in Australia, they usually think of kangaroos or koala bears. So it is surprising to learn that there are also many wild camels living in the country. In fact, there are more wild camels living in Australia than in any other country in the world.

Camels were first taken to Australia in the middle of the 19th century. They were brought from places like Africa and India. Camels can travel up to 70 kilometers a day and survive without water for a long time. Because of this, people often used them in the deserts of central and western Australia, where the weather is very hot and dry. They rode the camels and used them to carry goods over long distances.

This changed in the 1920s. At that time, cars and trucks were becoming more common, so the camels were no longer needed. Most of them were set free in the desert by their owners. Because there were no local animals that killed camels for food, their number grew very quickly. According to some experts, there are now about 1 million wild camels living in Australia, and their number is increasing rapidly each year.

In the past, when there were fewer camels, they did not cause many problems. Now, however, they have begun to harm trees and plants. Also, when they move to areas of farmland, they drink water and eat grass that is used for cows and sheep. For these reasons, the Australian government wants to control their number. One way to do this is to catch them so that they can be kept on farms and sold for their meat. However, many of the camels will remain in the desert and continue to remind people of Australia's interesting history.

(42)

People are usually surprised to learn that

- 1 camels originally came from Australia.
- 2 there are not enough camels in the world.
- 3 there are a lot of wild camels in Australia.
- 4 kangaroos belong to the same family as camels.

(43)

Why were camels used in central and western Australia?

- 1 They were able to live without food for 70 days.
- 2 They were able to work in hot and dry weather.
- 3 They could easily be found in the desert.
- 4 They could be taken to Africa and India safely.

(44)

After the 1920s, the number of camels grew quickly because

- 1 no other animals killed them for food.
- 2 they were cheaper than cars and trucks.
- 3 experts said they should be protected.
- 4 many people kept them as pets.

(45)

What is one reason the Australian government wants to control the number of camels?

- 1 It worries that camels may attack cows and sheep.
- 2 It wants to improve the quality of camel meat.
- 3 The camels are bad for the image of the country.
- 4 The camels are causing damage to trees and plants.

Dirty Eating

For most people, earth is something that should not be eaten. For this reason, they wash vegetables carefully before they cook them. However, many people around the world eat earth on purpose. This custom is most common in Africa and South America, but some people in the United States and other Western countries also eat earth.

People who eat earth usually do this for their (**36**). This is because it contains many things that the body needs, such as calcium and iron. In addition, some types of clay* can be used as medicine for the stomach. For these reasons, in parts of Africa, women who are going to have a baby sometimes eat clay. They say it stops them from feeling sick, and that it helps the babies inside them to grow.

Small children often put earth into their mouths when they are playing outside. Parents usually try to stop them from doing this. Some experts, though, believe that it may have (**37**) for children. They explain that the bacteria in the earth can help children's bodies fight diseases. They say that children who have contact with earth are less likely to get sick when they grow up.

However, there is no doubt that eating earth can also be (**38**). In many places, the soil contains harmful chemicals used by farmers. Moreover, harmful bacteria and insect eggs can enter the body along with the earth. According to experts, when people do eat earth, it is important that they make sure to get it from places that are known to be safe.

*clay: ねんど 粘土

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|------|-------------|----------|------------|---------------|
| (36) | 1 fashion | 2 health | 3 vacation | 4 information |
| (37) | 1 tests | 2 limits | 3 warnings | 4 advantages |
| (38) | 1 dangerous | 2 boring | 3 tasty | 4 cheap |

A Famous Desk

One of the most famous pieces of furniture in the United States is a large desk known as the *Resolute* desk. This wooden desk belongs to the White House, and it has been used by many American presidents. The *Resolute* desk is over 120 years old and has a very interesting history. In 1845, an English explorer named Sir John Franklin set out from England with two ships to look for a new route to Asia through the Arctic Ocean. Franklin hoped that this would make travel between Europe and Asia faster. However, Franklin and his ships disappeared. In 1848, several ships, including a ship called the *Resolute* that belonged to the British navy, were sent to the Arctic to search for them.

The captain of the *Resolute* planned to spend two years searching for the missing ships. However, he failed to find them. Then the *Resolute* itself became trapped in ice. The captain waited for the ice to melt, but he eventually gave up and decided to return to Britain, leaving his ship behind. He and his crew walked over the ice and sailed home in the other ships that had been sent to the Arctic. Later, the *Resolute* was discovered by an American fishing boat and taken to a port in Connecticut.

At that time, the relationship between Britain and the United States was not very good, but the American government decided to repair and return the ship. In 1856, it arrived back in Britain. For the next 23 years, the *Resolute* was used by the British navy. After the navy stopped using the ship, Queen Victoria ordered a desk to be made from its wood. She sent the desk to President Rutherford B. Hayes to thank the Americans. Today, the *Resolute* desk continues to be an important symbol of the friendship between the United States and Britain.

(42) Why did the *Resolute* leave Britain in 1848?

- 1 To search for a ship that belonged to the American navy.
- 2 To take a gift to the president of the United States.
- 3 To look for two ships that had become lost.
- 4 To find a faster route between Europe and Asia.

(43) The captain of the *Resolute*

- 1 took his crew back to Britain without his ship.
- 2 decided to leave his ship in a port in Connecticut.
- 3 found an American fishing boat that was trapped in the ice.
- 4 hoped to improve Britain's relationship with the United States.

(44) What happened to the *Resolute* in 1856?

- 1 It was broken up to make furniture.
- 2 It was found near the United States.
- 3 It was repaired by the British navy.
- 4 It was returned to the British.

(45) What is one thing we learn about the *Resolute* desk?

- 1 It was made using wood from an American fishing boat.
- 2 It was given to President Rutherford B. Hayes by Queen Victoria.
- 3 The American government bought it from the British navy.
- 4 The British still hope that the Americans will return it.

Red Telephone Boxes

At the beginning of the 20th century, few people in Britain had a telephone in their home. The only way most people could make calls was to use a public telephone. At first, most public telephones were in stores, and people had to pay the store clerk to use them. As time passed, though, public telephone boxes began to be built (**36**). These allowed people to make calls on the street without being heard by other people. They also protected people from the rain. They were usually painted bright red. For many people, these red telephone boxes became a symbol of British life.

One problem with telephone boxes was that people sometimes damaged them by breaking their windows, writing on them, or trying to steal money from the telephones. In the 1980s and 1990s, it became more and more expensive to keep Britain's red telephone boxes in good condition. The telephone company began to replace them with ones that were easier to look after. However, many people did not like the (**37**) of these new telephone boxes. They preferred the look of the old red ones.

Some of the red telephone boxes have been sold to people who use them in (**38**) ways. Some have become decorations in gardens. Red telephone boxes have also been used in clothing stores as changing rooms. On one beach, there are even telephone-box showers for people who want to wash the sand off their feet. Communities that still have working red telephone boxes are often very proud of them and do their best to look after them.

- | | | | | |
|------|-------------|---------------|------------|-------------|
| (36) | 1 outside | 2 silently | 3 quickly | 4 nearby |
| (37) | 1 weight | 2 price | 3 design | 4 cause |
| (38) | 1 dangerous | 2 traditional | 3 familiar | 4 different |

Horses to the Rescue

There are many search-and-rescue teams in North America that help people who become lost or hurt in forests and mountains. In places that are difficult to reach with cars or other vehicles, members of search-and-rescue teams sometimes use horses. Rescuers can travel further on horseback than they can on foot, and the horses can also carry equipment and injured people.

Recently, though, a horse trainer named Terry Nowacki has been showing that horses can be used for more than just transportation. Nowacki says that horses—just like dogs—can be trained to use their sense of smell to find people. Several years ago, Nowacki heard that there was a shortage of search-and-rescue dogs in his area, so he decided to try to train his horse Stormy to do the same type of work.

Nowacki says that training Stormy was surprisingly easy because horses find it easy to recognize the smell of humans. They also seem to enjoy looking for them. Nowacki would ask a stranger to hide on his farm, and then Stormy would look for him. When Stormy led Nowacki to the stranger, Nowacki gave the horse something to eat as a reward. Nowacki says that looking for people seems like a game to horses.

Since then, Nowacki has taught his methods to a number of search-and-rescue teams. He says that the people on the teams always need more training than their horses. The most important thing is for riders to learn about their horses' body language. For example, a horse might move its head in a certain way when it has picked up the smell of a human. Then the rider must allow the horse to follow the smell. Nowacki is confident that his techniques will help rescuers to save many lives in the future.

- (42) Search-and-rescue teams in North America sometimes
- 1 buy horses because they are cheaper than cars.
 - 2 help horses that have been injured in accidents.
 - 3 ride on horses to reach people who are in trouble.
 - 4 look for horses that are lost in forests and mountains.

- (43) Why did Terry Nowacki start training his horse Stormy to help search-and-rescue teams?
- 1 One of his friends had become lost.
 - 2 There were not enough trained dogs.
 - 3 It had a better sense of smell than his other horses.
 - 4 He had already trained other animals to find people.

- (44) What is one reason that training Stormy was easier than Nowacki had expected?
- 1 Stormy remembered the area around the farm very well.
 - 2 Stormy was happy to find people without getting extra food.
 - 3 Stormy knew the people he was searching for.
 - 4 Stormy seemed to enjoy doing the work.

- (45) When Nowacki trains search-and-rescue teams, he tells riders to
- 1 learn the meaning of their horses' movements.
 - 2 move their heads in the same way their horses do.
 - 3 teach the people they rescue about his techniques.
 - 4 help their horses recognize the smells of other horses.

[B]

Flying Messengers

Today, when we have something to tell people, we can make a phone call or send an e-mail. But what did people do in the past when they wanted to share information quickly? One way was to use homing pigeons. These birds are born with the ability to return to their nests from almost anywhere. They can even fly home from thousands of kilometers away without training. Throughout history, people have made use of this (36) talent.

In ancient Greece, for example, athletes who went to the Olympic Games sometimes took a homing pigeon with them. If the athlete won a race, to let people know, he would tie a piece of the finishing line to one of the pigeon's legs and let the bird fly back to his village. Homing pigeons were also used during wars to carry messages that people did not want their enemies to read. This was because they traveled fast and were not likely to get (37) by the enemy.

Pigeons cannot carry heavy packages, so messages were written on small pieces of paper and had to be short. However, after the 1840s, people were able to avoid this (38) thanks to a new method of creating very small photographs. Using this method, many messages could be printed on a small piece of film. This film was sent by pigeon, and the messages were shown on a screen. In the Franco-Prussian War of 1870–71, this method was used to send thousands of official messages and private letters. Because of their important role, the pigeons were seen as heroes.

- | | | | |
|----------------|-----------|-------------|-----------|
| (36) 1 natural | 2 lonely | 3 dangerous | 4 musical |
| (37) 1 sold | 2 frozen | 3 paid | 4 caught |
| (38) 1 advice | 2 problem | 3 trip | 4 damage |

Spelling Bees

People who study English as a foreign language often find it hard to learn the spelling of English words. But spelling can also be difficult for native speakers of English. Teachers in the United States sometimes use a contest called a “spelling bee” to help their students become more interested in spelling. The rules of a spelling bee are simple. The teacher reads a word out loud, and a student has to say the letters of the word. If the student makes a mistake, he or she must leave the contest. The last student remaining is the winner.

Students who do well in school spelling bees can go on to local and state contests. If they continue to be successful, they have the chance to take part in a national contest called the Scripps National Spelling Bee. Since 2006, the final rounds of this spelling bee have been shown live on television. The contest has become very popular, and it is watched by millions of people.

To win the Scripps National Spelling Bee, students must train very hard. Nearly 300 of the best spellers from schools all around the United States gather for the finals in Washington, D.C., every year. Students who take part in the contest practice spelling for many hours every day to prepare. They each receive an official word list for the contest that contains 23,000 words. Many students try to memorize the whole list.

However, not everyone thinks that spelling bees are a good idea. To do well in a spelling bee, students only need to be able to spell words. They do not have to know what they mean. Some people say that it would be better to spend time in class on activities that help students understand the meanings of words. In fact, many of the words in the final of the national contest are so unusual that most people have never even heard of them.

- (42) In a spelling bee, students
- 1 stay in the contest until they spell a word wrongly.
 - 2 are often asked to spell words in a foreign language.
 - 3 must write down the words that their teacher says.
 - 4 have to make a list of words they are interested in.
- (43) To get the chance to take part in the Scripps National Spelling Bee, students must
- 1 be picked by millions of television viewers.
 - 2 get a recommendation from their teachers.
 - 3 become popular with other students.
 - 4 do well in local and state contests.
- (44) Students who take part in the Scripps National Spelling Bee often
- 1 practice spelling the names of the cities that have hosted the contest.
 - 2 go to many places to meet the best spellers in the United States.
 - 3 try to remember all of the words on a list they are given.
 - 4 spend hours learning how to spell the names of other students.
- (45) According to some people, what is one bad point about spelling bees?
- 1 They teach students to use too many difficult words.
 - 2 They do not help students to learn the meanings of words.
 - 3 They stop students from doing outdoor activities like sports.
 - 4 They take away time needed to prepare for national contests.

Bicycle Power

The Tour de France, a cycling race that takes place over three weeks in July, is one of the world's most popular sporting events. Every year, about 14 million people stand along the sides of roads in France to watch the riders. (36), the race is shown live on television in more than 50 countries. The history of the Tour de France goes back over 100 years.

At the end of the 19th century, cycling races were becoming more common in France. Most of these were held on tracks in special arenas, but a few were on regular roads. People enjoyed reading about these road races in newspapers and magazines. In 1902, Henri Desgrange, the editor of a sports magazine called *L'Auto*, had the idea of organizing a 2,400-kilometer race through France. He hoped that the race would help his company (37) more magazines. The following year, *L'Auto* held the first Tour de France. Although only 21 cyclists finished, it was a success for Desgrange because many people were interested in the race. Thanks to the race, the number of people who bought *L'Auto* doubled.

Later, the race was made even longer, and new stages through the mountains were added. Some of the riders became (38) for their strength and fighting spirit. In 1913, for example, Eugène Christophe broke his bicycle while riding through the Pyrenees Mountains. He carried it 16 kilometers back to the nearest village, borrowed tools to repair it, and then continued the race. As a result, he became well known throughout France. Today, the Tour de France is still known as one of the toughest events in any sport.

- | | | | | |
|------|---------------|--------------|---------|-----------|
| (36) | 1 In addition | 2 By mistake | 3 Sadly | 4 Instead |
| (37) | 1 check | 2 order | 3 keep | 4 sell |
| (38) | 1 necessary | 2 famous | 3 sorry | 4 ready |

Oral Lee Brown

In the United States, graduating from college is often seen as one important path to success. For many children from poorer areas, however, going to college is an impossible dream. In 1987, a woman named Oral Lee Brown decided to do something to make that dream come true for a small group of children from a poor area of East Oakland, in California.

Brown says she got her idea after a little girl asked her for money in the street. Brown guessed that the girl was not getting enough to eat at home, so she took her to a grocery store to buy food. This experience made Brown start thinking about the problems of poor children in her area. She visited the local elementary school and met many children who needed help. After talking with the principal, Brown made a promise to the 23 students in one first-year class. She said that if they agreed to study hard and graduate from high school, she would pay for them to go to college.

Brown knew that she would have to work hard to keep this promise. She had a good job, but she was not rich. She started saving \$10,000 of her own money each year. She also organized events and asked companies to give money. But Brown did not just collect money for the students. She also gave them extra lessons on her days off, bought them Christmas presents, and listened to their problems.

It was hard for the students, too. Many high school students in East Oakland leave school before they graduate, but Brown encouraged the students she met in 1987 to continue. Twelve years later, in 1999, she was very happy because 19 of the original 23 had gone on to college. Since then, Brown has set up an organization called the Oral Lee Brown Foundation to help give other children the opportunity to get a college education.

(42) In 1987, Oral Lee Brown decided to

- 1** save money to start a school in East Oakland.
 - 2** send her children to a college in East Oakland.
 - 3** ask children in East Oakland about their dreams.
 - 4** help some children in East Oakland go to college.
-

(43) How did Brown get her idea?

- 1** She started teaching at a local elementary school.
 - 2** She went to the graduation ceremony at a college.
 - 3** She met someone who made her think about poor children.
 - 4** She saw many people buying unhealthy food in a grocery store.
-

(44) What is one thing Brown did for the students?

- 1** She taught them in her free time.
 - 2** She helped them save their money.
 - 3** She took them on trips at Christmas.
 - 4** She found jobs for them at local companies.
-

(45) Why was Brown happy in 1999?

- 1** A new college opened in East Oakland.
- 2** She was able to meet the students again.
- 3** Most of the students had been able to enter college.
- 4** Her organization had become large and successful.

E-mail at the Office

E-mails are a useful tool for business because they can be sent almost instantly to computers anywhere in the world. (36), many office workers say that they get too many e-mails. Research by the University of Glasgow and the University of Paisley in Scotland found that one-third of e-mail users experience stress because of the number of e-mails that they have to reply to. Also, many companies have found that e-mails sometimes stop employees from doing other work. The researchers found that some workers check their e-mail as often as 30 to 40 times an hour.

Because of these difficulties, some companies have introduced “No E-mail Fridays.” This was first done at a British company where it was found that employees were sending e-mails even though it would have been quicker to have a conversation. Usually on No E-mail Fridays, the companies still allow employees to use e-mail if it is very important. But they tell them to try to find other ways to (37). For example, instead of sending an e-mail, employees should call customers on the telephone or go to a co-worker’s desk to talk.

Some companies say that these No E-mail Fridays have been a great success. One small shipping company in the United States reported that its employees were (38) and got more work done. But at other companies, No E-mail Fridays do not seem to have worked so well. Often, employees needed to answer even more e-mails on the next Monday morning. Nevertheless, experts say that the days remind employees how important it is to send only e-mails that are necessary.

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|------|-------------|------------|-----------|---------------|
| (36) | 1 Otherwise | 2 However | 3 Besides | 4 Luckily |
| (37) | 1 relax | 2 practice | 3 leave | 4 communicate |
| (38) | 1 later | 2 safer | 3 happier | 4 younger |

A New Route

In recent years, elephants in the African country of Kenya have faced many problems. One is that more people are living in places that used to be completely wild. As a result, it has become hard for elephants to move around. When they look for food, they have to go through villages or cross farmland. Sometimes, villagers kill elephants because they think that they will harm people or damage crops.

Over the last 10 years, an organization called the Mount Kenya Trust has been putting up fences. It hopes these fences will stop such problems between elephants and humans. In 2010, the organization decided to create an “elephant corridor.” This is a 28-kilometer-long narrow path of land that elephants can walk along freely. The elephant corridor connects two areas where elephants live—the highlands of Mount Kenya and the forests of Ngare Ndare. Before, it was hard for elephants to travel between the two areas because of farmland, roads, and buildings.

To complete the elephant corridor, the Mount Kenya Trust built a tunnel under a highway. Some wildlife experts thought that this was a bad idea. They said that elephants would not want to use a tunnel made by humans. To make the tunnel more attractive, workers put grass inside it. The tunnel was completed near the end of December 2010. A few days later, on New Year’s Day, officials at the Mount Kenya Trust were pleased when a young male elephant known as Tony went through the tunnel.

After that, scientists from a group called Save the Elephants started checking the movements of Tony and six other elephants. They want to see how often they use the elephant corridor. If they find that the corridor is a success, the idea will probably be copied in other countries.

(42) One problem in Kenya is that

- 1** people find it hard to move from place to place.
- 2** tourists are eating food that is needed by local people.
- 3** elephants have to go through places where people live.
- 4** many wild areas are being damaged by elephants.

(43) Why did the Mount Kenya Trust build the elephant corridor?

- 1** To make it easier for villagers to catch dangerous elephants.
- 2** To create more areas that people could use to build farms on.
- 3** To allow elephants to move freely between two different areas.
- 4** To stop people from building in the forests of Ngare Ndare.

(44) After the tunnel was finished in December 2010,

- 1** people started building a new highway close to it.
- 2** officials had to close it to put more grass inside.
- 3** workers made it wider to attract more elephants.
- 4** an elephant named Tony went through it.

(45) What will probably happen if scientists find that the elephant corridor is working well?

- 1** Elephant corridors will be built in other countries.
- 2** The tunnel under the highway will be closed.
- 3** Save the Elephants will stop its activities in Kenya.
- 4** Scientists will check the movements of other animals.

Rock School

Many teenagers dream about performing in a rock band. When Sandra Rizkallah and her husband Tom Pugh heard their own teenage children talking about starting a band, they had an unusual (**36**). They decided to start a program at their home in Massachusetts for young people who want to play in a rock band. The program is called “Plugged In.” Students in the program practice singing and playing musical instruments, but they also learn how they can help other people through their music.

The students are first divided into groups of about five. Each group thinks of a band name and chooses songs to practice. The students are also asked what charities they are interested in. They then decide on which charity to (**37**). At the end of the program, the students perform in a concert. Tickets are sold, and the money made at the concert is given to the charity that they chose. In 2006, students raised enough money to send a student from Zimbabwe to college for four years.

Plugged In began in 2001 with just five students. It has grown since then, and now about 100 students take part each time. Rizkallah and Pugh say that there are several reasons why Plugged In is so (**38**). Some teenagers go to Plugged In either because they have no one to play with or because they have no place to rehearse. Others join because they want to become rich and famous. But Rizkallah and Pugh hope that the program will also show them how to use their talent to help others.

- | | | | | |
|------|-----------|---------|------------|--------------|
| (36) | 1 visit | 2 idea | 3 warning | 4 difficulty |
| (37) | 1 copy | 2 leave | 3 support | 4 describe |
| (38) | 1 popular | 2 safe | 3 relaxing | 4 clean |

Easter at the White House

Every spring, people in many countries celebrate the Christian holiday of Easter. In the United States, many families go to church at Easter. Many American parents also organize an Easter-egg hunt. In this game, parents and children decorate eggs. Then the parents hide the eggs for the children to find later. Another tradition is Easter-egg rolling. This is a race in which children push eggs through grass using a spoon with a long handle. The most famous Easter-egg roll is held at the White House—the home of the American president.

The tradition of the White House Easter Egg Roll began in 1878. Before that, children gathered every Easter to roll eggs in a park in another part of Washington, D.C. But some people were unhappy because the children damaged the grass. From 1876, the police stopped children from playing the game in this park. When President Rutherford B. Hayes heard that children could not roll eggs there, he felt sorry for them. He invited them to an Easter-egg roll at the White House.

The event grew larger over the years, and 53,000 people came in 1941. Nowadays, however, the number of guests is usually under 30,000. Presidents have often made changes to the event to try to improve it. In recent years, they have started inviting famous young singers to perform. In 2010, President Barack Obama asked Justin Bieber to appear. President Obama's staff also introduced an online system that allows children from all over the United States to apply for tickets on the Internet.

The White House Easter Egg Roll is expensive to organize, and some people say that it is a waste to spend so much money. However, some of the money is provided by companies, and the entertainers perform for free. It is also a rare chance for American children to come to the White House and meet the leader of their country.

(42) What is one thing many children in the United States do at Easter?

- 1** They hunt in the grass for spoons.
- 2** They decorate eggs with their parents.
- 3** They cook various dishes made with eggs.
- 4** They watch a speech by the president on TV.

(43) Why were children stopped from rolling eggs in a park in Washington, D.C.?

- 1** Some people did not want them to damage the grass.
- 2** The police thought that the game was dangerous.
- 3** There were not enough eggs available at that time.
- 4** The president said the park was too small for them to use.

(44) What is one way in which the White House Easter Egg Roll has changed?

- 1** Tickets are now much cheaper than before.
- 2** Children can now watch it live on the Internet.
- 3** More people come now than in 1941.
- 4** Some famous singers now perform at it.

(45) Why are some people unhappy about the White House Easter Egg Roll?

- 1** They do not like the entertainers who perform there.
- 2** They do not want children to meet the president.
- 3** They say companies use it only for advertising.
- 4** They say it costs too much money.

Toys for Pigs

In recent years, scientists have been learning more about the abilities of animals. One animal that is (**36**) than many people realize is the pig. Research has shown that pigs have good memories and can learn to do many things. But because pigs are so intelligent, they easily get bored. This can be a problem for pig farmers. Often, large numbers of pigs are kept inside buildings with little space to move around. In such conditions, pigs can become bored and unhappy. To stop this from happening, many farmers give their pigs toys to play with.

One toy for pigs was created by a scientist named Uwe Richter from the University of Kassel in Germany. His toy has three colorful plastic balls on a metal spring. The balls jump around when the pigs push them with their noses. Richter says he (**37**) the toy after seeing children playing with plastic balls in a playroom.

However, some people think that toys are not the best way to solve the problem. They say that it would be better to keep pigs in more (**38**) conditions. Pigs like to search through plants and dirt to find food. Richter himself points out that pigs are not interested in his toy when they are free to move around outside. They only play with it when there is nothing more interesting to do. His work—and that of other scientists—shows us how important it is to treat pigs and other animals well.

- | | | | | |
|------|-------------|-------------|------------|------------|
| (36) | 1 healthier | 2 smarter | 3 cleaner | 4 stronger |
| (37) | 1 enjoyed | 2 repaired | 3 designed | 4 dropped |
| (38) | 1 natural | 2 expensive | 3 crowded | 4 shocking |

The Soap Project

Derreck Kayongo is a businessman from the African country of Uganda who moved to the United States in the early 1990s. When he first arrived, he stayed at a hotel in Philadelphia. He noticed that the hotel staff put a new bar of soap in his room every morning even if he had only used the old bar once. The hotel gave each guest a new bar of soap every day and threw away the used bars. Kayongo was surprised to learn that many other hotels in the United States did the same thing.

He thought that it would be better to collect the used soap and give it to poor people in developing countries. Each year, many children in developing countries die from diseases caused by bacteria. People can easily prevent such diseases by washing their hands with soap. Kayongo points out that soap is sold in the places where these children live. The problem, however, is that many families cannot buy it because they have to spend their money on food and other important things like medicine.

In May 2009, many years after his experience at the hotel, Kayongo created an organization called the Global Soap Project. Hotels that take part in the project collect used bars of soap and send them to the organization. Volunteers separate the soap into different types. They are careful to put bars with the same color and smell together. The soap is then heated and made into new bars. Finally, the organization asks other charities to take the new soap to developing countries and hand it out to people who need it.

So far, over 600 hotels have joined the Global Soap Project. Recycling the soap costs the hotels a little money, and it is hard work for the volunteers. But Kayongo and the volunteers think that the work of the organization is important not only because it helps to prevent diseases, but also because it reduces waste from hotels.

-
- (42) In the early 1990s, Derreck Kayongo found out that
- 1 guests usually took soap home from hotels.
 - 2 staff at hotels had to buy soap for themselves.
 - 3 the soap given to hotel guests was often quite old.
 - 4 hotels in the United States threw away a lot of soap.
-

- (43) Kayongo says that in developing countries,
- 1 many families make their own soap at home.
 - 2 many families do not have enough money to buy soap.
 - 3 soap is not sold in places where poor people live.
 - 4 soap is too weak to prevent many diseases.
-

- (44) What does the Global Soap Project ask other charities to do?
- 1 Hand out its soap to people in need.
 - 2 Collect used bars of soap from hotels.
 - 3 Make new bars of soap from used ones.
 - 4 Check to make sure that its soap smells nice.
-

- (45) What is one reason that Kayongo thinks his organization's work is important?
- 1 It teaches people to wash using less soap.
 - 2 It allows volunteers to get free bars of soap.
 - 3 It helps to stop diseases in developing countries.
 - 4 It shows hotels how they can make extra money.

Staycations

Many people think of a vacation as a chance to visit a foreign country, swim at the beach, or ski in the mountains. But these days, more and more people in the United States are staying at home for their vacations. To describe this trend, the words “stay” and “vacation” have been put together to make the new word “staycation.” One explanation for this trend is that traveling can cost a lot. But being (36) is not the only reason why staycations are popular. Some people take staycations because they find it stressful to go to places that are far away. Others just want to enjoy being at home.

People who take staycations seem to agree that it is important to plan them like regular vacations. The way to do this is to choose special (37) for each day. This is what the Taylor family from Dallas, Texas, did. After deciding to take a staycation with their children, Joslyn Taylor and her husband used the Internet to research places to visit in Dallas. They found several museums, theaters, and parks they had never been to before.

Taylor says one thing that can be difficult during a staycation is getting away from work. For this reason, she told her co-workers that she did not want them to contact her during her staycation. This really helped her to (38). Without having to answer phone calls and e-mails, she was able to forget about her job. It seems that a vacation at home can be just as enjoyable as a trip to somewhere else.

- | | | | | |
|------|-----------|--------------|-----------|------------|
| (36) | 1 private | 2 natural | 3 shorter | 4 cheaper |
| (37) | 1 hotels | 2 activities | 3 music | 4 gifts |
| (38) | 1 study | 2 pay | 3 relax | 4 remember |

Monterey Bay

Sometimes it seems that all of the news about the environment is negative. Every day, we hear stories about global warming and rainforests being cut down. This can make people believe that it is impossible for humans to stop damaging nature. However, there is good news, too, and these positive stories can teach us lessons about how to fix some of our environmental problems. One example is California's Monterey Bay.

Monterey Bay is home to many different sea animals, and one of the most well known is the sea otter.* Starting in the 1700s, people began hunting these small animals for their furs, and by the 1850s there were very few left in the bay. Sea otters eat shellfish called abalones, and without the sea otters, the number of abalones grew very fast. But fishermen began to catch many abalones, and in the 1860s these became very rare, too. Without food for the sea otters to eat, it was very difficult to bring them back to the bay.

In the 1930s, a woman named Julia Platt wanted to do something about the bay's problems. She created a small, protected area of Monterey Bay where hunting and fishing were not allowed. As a result, the number of abalones increased greatly. After a while, sea otters began returning to the area where the abalones lived. Because there was enough food for them to eat, the number of sea otters slowly grew.

People saw the success of Platt's idea and decided to protect much bigger areas of Monterey Bay. Since then, whales and other animals have returned to the bay. A huge aquarium has also been built next to the bay to educate people about the importance of taking better care of the oceans. Monterey Bay has become a major tourist area and shows that protecting even a small piece of nature can have an important effect on the environment.

*sea otter: ラッコ

(42) California's Monterey Bay area is an example of

- 1** a story about the environment that was not true.
- 2** a serious problem created by global warming.
- 3** a place where damage to nature has been repaired.
- 4** a rainforest that has been cut down and grown again.

(43) Why did the number of abalones in Monterey Bay grow quickly in the 1850s?

- 1** Sea otters started hunting other animals.
- 2** Many sea otters had been killed by humans.
- 3** Some fishermen started leaving food for the abalones.
- 4** Fishermen brought new types of shellfish to the bay.

(44) What happened after a protected area was created in Monterey Bay?

- 1** Hunters were only allowed to catch three sea otters each year.
- 2** Fishermen complained that they could not catch abalones.
- 3** The abalones did not have enough food to eat.
- 4** The number of sea otters in the bay began to increase.

(45) Monterey Bay's aquarium

- 1** has been successful because of its popular animal shows.
- 2** has attracted whales and other kinds of sea life to the area.
- 3** was built to teach people why the oceans need to be protected.
- 4** was the first place to take care of sea otters in Monterey Bay.

Dinner Tickets

In 2012, a new restaurant called Next opened in Chicago. Grant Achatz, one of America's most famous chefs, started the restaurant, and it soon became one of the most popular restaurants in the city. But Next is not a (36) restaurant. What makes it different from other restaurants is that people who want to eat there must buy a ticket before they go. Also, the same meal is served to everyone in the restaurant.

Achatz says that he decided to sell tickets for Next because he wants the dinners there to be special events. Every three months, Next creates a new meal with a different theme. For example, one time it offered dishes that people in Paris used to eat more than a hundred years ago. Everyone eats the same dinner, but it is a special one that is only served for a limited time. Although they cannot (37) what they eat, people enjoy going to Next because it is such a unique dining experience.

Once you buy a ticket for Next, you cannot get your money back, but you can sell your ticket to someone else. Thanks to this system, the restaurant knows exactly how many meals to prepare each day. Even if customers suddenly decide not to go, the restaurant does not lose money. This is because the customers have already (38). As a result, the restaurant can offer high-quality food at lower prices than other high-class restaurants. If Next's system continues to be successful, more restaurants may try selling tickets in the future.

- | | | | | |
|------|------------|----------|-----------|---------|
| (36) | 1 friendly | 2 small | 3 normal | 4 quiet |
| (37) | 1 choose | 2 finish | 3 taste | 4 bring |
| (38) | 1 rested | 2 left | 3 changed | 4 paid |

A New Kind of Park

In many large cities, building parks and green spaces for the people who live there is very difficult. This is especially true in crowded places like New York City, where land for parks not only costs a lot but is also hard to find. For this reason, New York City has been finding creative ways to build new parks. One park, for example, has been built high above the streets on an old railroad line that is no longer being used. Now, people are even talking about an idea for a new park under the ground.

A group in New York City is planning to build a park in an old underground trolley depot.* The city used the depot between 1903 and 1948, but it has been empty since then. It is known as the Delancey Underground, and the group believes that the new park would help to create a relaxing public space in the crowded part of New York City called Manhattan.

The park's designers, Dan Barasch and James Ramsey, have found a way to allow trees and plants to grow underground. Their idea is to use natural light. They are planning to use a new technology that can send natural light through cables. The designers say that this will give trees and plants enough light to grow in the park.

Because the park would be located underground, it would be possible to hold events there throughout the year. The designers hope that, in addition to usual park activities like picnics and walking dogs, people could enjoy art exhibitions and other events in all kinds of weather. It may take a few years for the Delancey Underground park to be built, but if Barasch and Ramsey are successful, New York City will be home to the world's first park below the ground.

*trolley depot: 路面電車の車庫

(42) What is one problem New York City has?

- 1** The ground is too soft to build parks on.
 - 2** People do not want to go to parks anymore.
 - 3** Many of its old parks can no longer be used.
 - 4** It is difficult to find enough space to build parks.
-

(43) The Delancey Underground

- 1** has not been used for many years.
 - 2** was sold by the city government in 1948.
 - 3** is one of the most crowded places in Manhattan.
 - 4** was not big enough for trolleys.
-

(44) What problem will Dan Barasch and James Ramsey solve by using new technology?

- 1** How to move an old city park underground.
 - 2** How to pay for a new public space.
 - 3** How to grow trees where there is not enough light.
 - 4** How to hide the cables used in the park.
-

(45) What will be one advantage of the underground park?

- 1** People will not lose their pets.
- 2** Events can be held there in bad weather.
- 3** It can be built quickly and cheaply.
- 4** There will not be much noise.

The History of Purple

Until a few hundred years ago, only the richest people wore purple clothes. For example, kings and queens wore purple as a sign of their high rank. Because of this, many people thought of it as a color that only powerful people could wear. The reason that purple clothes were so special was that, until the 19th century, purple was a very (**36**) color to make.

Thousands of years ago, a way to make purple cloth was discovered in a country in the Middle East known as Phoenicia, but it took a lot of time and effort. The Phoenicians made the color from a shellfish called “murex,” and it took 250,000 of these shellfish just to make about 30 grams of purple color. (**37**), it was very expensive. The Phoenicians sold it to the Greeks and the Romans, but few people could use it because of the price. Later, in around A.D. 400, a Roman law was made so that only the emperor could wear clothes made with the best purple cloth.

During the 15th century, people started looking for new ways to make purple color. For example, some people tried using various types of insects or fish. They were successful, and this made purple clothing a little cheaper. However, it was still too expensive for most people. Then, in 1856, a scientist named William H. Perkin discovered a chemical called “mauveine.” This made it possible for ordinary people to (**38**) purple clothes. The color soon became very fashionable, and today purple clothing can be found in almost any store.

- | | | | | |
|------|-------------|-----------|-------------|----------------|
| (36) | 1 strange | 2 clean | 3 difficult | 4 gentle |
| (37) | 1 Therefore | 2 Luckily | 3 Before | 4 Surprisingly |
| (38) | 1 return | 2 wash | 3 forget | 4 buy |

Driving for the Earth

Most people know that taking a bus is safer and less expensive than driving a car. Also, riding buses is better for the environment. However, buses are not a perfect answer to environmental problems. One reason for this is because they use more fuel than they need to. Because of this, some people say that bus drivers should be trained to practice “eco-driving.”

Eco-driving means helping the environment by driving in a way that uses less fuel. A large amount of fuel is wasted when bus drivers do certain things, such as speeding up quickly or leaving the engine on when the bus is not moving. Some cities have started to train their bus drivers to stop doing these things to save both fuel and money. In order to teach bus drivers eco-driving, SmartDrive, a company in the United States, has recently developed a special system.

The system uses small lights to tell the driver how he or she is driving. It is put on the bus in a place that the driver can easily see. A green light comes on when the driver is driving well. A red light, on the other hand, tells the driver that he or she is wasting fuel. The idea is to teach the drivers while they are driving. In a test study, SmartDrive found that they could improve drivers’ fuel savings by as much as 18.7 percent.

Stagecoach Bus, a company in the United Kingdom, uses a system similar to SmartDrive’s. According to Stagecoach Bus, another benefit of eco-driving is that it is safer. The company says that they are using the system both to lower fuel costs and to reduce traffic accidents. To do this, Stagecoach Bus is offering its drivers extra money if they can improve their driving style. These new systems are helping to make taking the bus an even better option for the future.

(42) What is one problem with buses?

- 1** It is hard to train the drivers.
 - 2** It is hard to make them safer than cars.
 - 3** They use more fuel than is needed.
 - 4** They use an expensive kind of fuel.
-

(43) “Eco-driving” means

- 1** keeping buses moving as much as possible.
 - 2** changing the engines in buses to ones that need less fuel.
 - 3** making drivers pay money when they harm the environment.
 - 4** driving in ways that are better for the environment.
-

(44) How does the SmartDrive system work?

- 1** It uses lights to tell drivers how well they are driving.
 - 2** It has a red light to tell drivers when to turn on the engine.
 - 3** It tests people on how much they know about global warming.
 - 4** It stores fuel in another part of the bus so that it is not wasted.
-

(45) What is one thing that Stagecoach Bus is trying to do?

- 1** Get a prize for their eco-driving system.
- 2** Create a new type of bus that uses no fuel.
- 3** Make money by teaching drivers at other bus companies.
- 4** Reduce the number of accidents caused by poor driving.

The Phonograph

Until about 200 years ago, there was no recorded sound. When people wanted to hear music, they could not just listen to CDs. Instead, they needed someone to (**36**) it for them. However, in the 1800s, some people began trying to make machines that could record sounds. Then, in 1877, Thomas Edison invented a machine called the phonograph that could do this.

The phonograph recorded sounds onto a kind of tube called a cylinder, which was made from a very thin sheet of metal. The machine recorded the sound by cutting small lines into the cylinder, but the thin metal was not very strong. Because of this, each recording could only be listened to (**37**). To solve this problem, Edison began making cylinders out of wax.* These were stronger, so people could listen to a recording many times before the cylinders broke.

However, because of the cylinders' shape, it was difficult to make copies of recordings. A different inventor, Emile Berliner, (**38**) this situation. In 1887, Berliner invented a new machine called the gramophone, which used flat discs instead of cylinders. Because the discs were flat, it was much easier to make copies of them. Also, these discs could hold longer recordings. Soon, people began recording music onto the discs, and they could listen to it whenever they wanted.

*wax: ろう, ワックス

- | | | | | |
|------|-------------|-----------|----------|-----------|
| (36) | 1 buy | 2 play | 3 fix | 4 return |
| (37) | 1 once | 2 loudly | 3 alone | 4 cheaply |
| (38) | 1 explained | 2 counted | 3 shared | 4 changed |

Plane Trees

The French countryside is known for the beautiful long lines of trees that grow along the sides of roads and rivers. Most of these trees are a kind called plane trees. These trees have been a part of the French countryside for centuries. They were first planted for wood and to give shade along the roads. Now, however, these trees are in danger.

One danger for the trees is a disease that was accidentally brought to France from America by soldiers during World War II. Since then, thousands of plane trees along the Canal du Midi, a man-made river built in the 17th century, have caught this disease. These trees are being cut down to keep the disease from spreading, but this is bad for the river because the roots of the trees are needed to protect the walls of the river. New trees are being planted, but they will take many years to grow.

Another danger, however, comes from people who want to cut them down for other reasons. One reason they want to do this is that a large number of people die in accidents in which cars hit the plane trees. As a result, some trees have been cut down to try to make roads safer. For example, a group of motorcycle riders cut down about 100 of the trees after a rider died in an accident. Even the French Minister of Agriculture has said that all the trees should be cut down.

However, some people disagree. They say that the trees are not the problem. These people believe that such accidents are caused by people driving too fast. Chantal Fauché, a French woman who is trying to save the trees, says that even if the trees are removed, bad drivers will continue to have accidents. Still, the number of these trees has gone down from around 3 million to 250,000 over the last 100 years.

(42)

The plane trees in France

- 1 are in danger because too many people use them for wood.
- 2 sometimes grow in the middle of roads.
- 3 have been grown in the countryside for hundreds of years.
- 4 were planted to make rivers look beautiful.

(43)

What happened in France during World War II?

- 1 Many plane trees were cut down to make room for buildings.
- 2 American soldiers accidentally destroyed an important road.
- 3 A disease that affects plane trees was brought from America.
- 4 A man-made river was built by the French government.

(44)

Why do some people think that plane trees are dangerous?

- 1 The Minister of Agriculture says the trees make it hard for drivers to see.
- 2 The trees sometimes fall onto roads and cause car accidents.
- 3 A group of motorcycle riders died while cutting some trees down.
- 4 A lot of people have died after hitting the trees while driving.

(45)

Chantal Fauché

- 1 thinks that removing plane trees does not help road safety.
- 2 believes that better roads will help people go to places faster.
- 3 wants to reduce the number of plane trees in France to 250,000.
- 4 says that it can take over 100 years for a new plane tree to grow.

A Challenge for Bookstores

Over the past few years, many bookstores in the United States and Europe have been having a hard time staying in business. More and more people have started buying books on the Internet, and new technologies such as electronic books have become very popular. (36), the number of books sold in bookstores has gone down, and many small bookshops have had to close. However, some bookstores are finding new ways to attract customers.

Some of these bookstores now sell coffee and have places where customers can sit and relax. Others have started to sell items like wine or children's toys along with the books. One bookshop owner in Massachusetts began offering Spanish classes in his store. Another bookseller rents the space in his store to people that want to have parties. However, many bookstore owners do not like these (37). They say that using them does not actually help the stores to sell their main product—books.

Now, there might be a new way to help bookstores. Researchers from Hasselt University in Belgium did an experiment on smells in bookstores. They found that when the smell of chocolate is in the air, people take their time and look at more books. In their experiment, the sales of popular genres such as romance novels and books about food and drink went up by 40 percent when the store used the smell. The experiment suggests that this could be an inexpensive way to help bookstores stay (38).

- | | | | | |
|------|-----------|--------------|--------------|---------------|
| (36) | 1 Even so | 2 By the way | 3 Once again | 4 As a result |
| (37) | 1 reasons | 2 magazines | 3 ideas | 4 machines |
| (38) | 1 open | 2 warm | 3 free | 4 dry |

Geese Police

For thousands of years, people have used guard dogs to protect their homes. This is because dogs have good hearing and bark loudly when strangers are near. However, criminals have found many ways to avoid being caught by guard dogs, such as giving them food with drugs in it. Because of this, police in an area of China called Xinjiang have started using a different animal for guarding places—geese.*

The Chinese police are using geese to help guard police stations at night. These birds are actually good at protecting places because they have very good hearing and can see much better than people can. They can also be very noisy, and it is difficult to calm them down once they have started making noise. For instance, when a man quietly tried to steal a motorbike from a police station in Xinjiang, a group of 20 guard geese began screaming and woke up a police officer. The officer then caught the man.

Zhang Quansheng, the chief of police for Shawan County in Xinjiang, says that he thinks geese are better at guarding than dogs. This is because geese are kept in large numbers, so it is difficult for a criminal to kill or give drugs to all of the geese in a short time. Also, if a criminal tries to give the geese food, they get more excited and become noisier. Dogs, on the other hand, become quiet.

Another advantage of using geese is that they are easy to take care of. They do not need expensive food, and they usually do not fly away from their homes. According to Patrick Cumins, a bird expert, some farmers in the United States are also using geese to protect chickens. However, even though geese are good at guarding, they are not able to replace dogs for other jobs, such as helping the blind.

*goose: ガチョウ（複数形：geese）

(42) What is one problem with using dogs to guard places?

- 1** Their hearing is not very good.
 - 2** Their owners do not notice them barking.
 - 3** They are usually too friendly.
 - 4** They can be given food with drugs.
-

(43) What happened when a man tried to steal a motorbike in Xinjiang?

- 1** Guard geese helped the police to stop him from doing it.
 - 2** Guard geese heard him even though the dogs could not.
 - 3** He screamed loudly and woke up the guard geese.
 - 4** He was unable to see where the guard geese were kept.
-

(44) If a criminal gives food to guard geese, they

- 1** might become nicer towards the criminal.
 - 2** might fall asleep very quickly.
 - 3** will gather into large groups.
 - 4** will start to make more noise.
-

(45) How are geese being used in the United States?

- 1** To replace dogs as popular pets.
- 2** To protect chickens on farms.
- 3** To guard food in homes from other animals.
- 4** To help blind people to find their way around.

Art Online

The Internet has had a big effect on our daily lives in many ways. For example, many people do their shopping and banking online. Recently, however, people have also begun to use the Internet to enjoy famous works of art that are in museums far away. Google and a museum in Spain called the Prado worked together on a project that lets people all over the world look at the museum's paintings using the Internet. Because of this project, many people now have the chance to see these works of art without (**36**).

First, experts at the Prado used special cameras to take more than 8,200 pictures of the paintings. After the pictures were taken, Google put them onto a special website. That way, anyone can view the images for free. The pictures that the cameras took are very high quality, and people can zoom in to see very small details in the paintings. This means that we can look at them (**37**) online than we can in the museum.

Then, in 2011, Google started a new project called the Google Art Project. In this, Google worked with 17 famous museums around the world. A camera was carried around the museums, and pictures were taken of the inside of the buildings as well as the art. This project allows Internet users to “walk” through the halls of the museums and look at art as if they were taking a tour. Just like the project with the Prado museum, users do not have to (**38**). Thanks to these projects, many people can now “visit” some of the world's greatest museums for free.

- | | | | | |
|------|---------------|--------------|----------------|-------------|
| (36) | 1 studying | 2 crying | 3 asking | 4 traveling |
| (37) | 1 more wildly | 2 less often | 3 more closely | 4 less fast |
| (38) | 1 care | 2 pay | 3 read | 4 talk |

Shoe Story

Many people around the world have been wearing shoes for most of their lives. In fact, many people are so used to wearing shoes that they cannot easily walk around outside without them. However, many thousands of years ago, there were no shoes. Researchers around the world have become interested in knowing when shoes were invented, and they have been learning more and more about the history of shoes.

Scientists think that humans started wearing clothes over 100,000 years ago. However, they say that we did not start wearing shoes until much later. Scientists compared the foot bones of people who wear shoes with those of people who do not. They found that people who wear shoes have smaller and weaker foot bones. The oldest foot bones like this come from people who lived 40,000 years ago in Asia.

However, scientists do not know what kind of shoes these people wore because none of their shoes have been found. In fact, the oldest shoes ever found are from about 10,000 years ago. These shoes were made from rope, and they were found in Oregon, in the United States. More recently, a small leather shoe from 5,500 years ago was found in Europe. Scientists think that this kind of shoe was made to protect people's feet from both the hard ground and the cold.

Some people, however, think that people in ancient cultures did not wear shoes only for protection. It is thought that they also cared about how their shoes looked. Manolo Blahnik, a famous shoe designer, looked at the leather shoe found in Europe. He thinks that different groups of ancient people probably had different styles of shoes. This might have made it easier for them to tell whether or not a person belonged to the same group as them. In this way, it seems that style might have also been important to ancient cultures.

(42)

What is true about many people in the world today?

- 1 They cannot get shoes that are big enough to fit their feet.
- 2 They are not interested in learning about the history of shoes.
- 3 They have trouble walking around outside without shoes.
- 4 They spend thousands of dollars on shoes in their lifetimes.

(43)

Scientists say that people

- 1 should start wearing shoes at an older age than they do now.
- 2 walked from Asia to North America 40,000 years ago.
- 3 created clothes 100,000 years earlier than they had thought.
- 4 started wearing clothing before they started wearing shoes.

(44)

The shoe found in Europe was

- 1 probably difficult to wear for a long time.
- 2 probably made to keep the feet safe and warm.
- 3 worn at least 10,000 years ago.
- 4 made of many small pieces of rope.

(45)

What does Manolo Blahnik think about ancient people?

- 1 Different groups of them wore different kinds of shoes.
- 2 Some groups wore shoes more often than others.
- 3 Leather shoes were not very important for them.
- 4 They did not care much about the appearance of their shoes.

On the Map

New Zealand is a nation made up of many islands, but most people live on the two largest. In English, these are called North Island and South Island. These names have been on maps since the 1800s, when many British people started living there. However, a different group of people, called the Maori, have been living in New Zealand (**36**). They already had their own names for the islands.

The Maori people first arrived in New Zealand around 900 years ago, and they have their own culture and language. The Maori name for North Island is Te Ika-a-Maui, which means “the fish of the hero Maui.” South Island, on the other hand, is called Te Waipounamu, which means “the waters of the greenstone.” The Maori names were sometimes written on maps until the 1950s. However, after that they (**37**). This is probably because English was the only official language at that time, and most people called the islands by their English names.

However, the New Zealand government made the Maori language into an official language in 1987. Then, in 2013, the government discovered that the islands had never been given official names. They asked the people of New Zealand which pair of names they wanted as the official names for the islands. Most people said that they liked the idea of having both pairs. The government decided to (**38**) the people’s idea. From now on, new maps of New Zealand will have the English names and the Maori names written on the islands.

- | | | | | |
|------|-----------|-------------|------------|---------------|
| (36) | 1 sadly | 2 healthily | 3 longer | 4 forever |
| (37) | 1 studied | 2 returned | 3 listened | 4 disappeared |
| (38) | 1 use | 2 sell | 3 forget | 4 change |

The Marathon of Hope

Terry Fox was born in the Canadian city of Winnipeg in 1958. As a teenager, he loved sports, and his dream was to become a P.E. teacher. However, in 1977, Fox's life changed forever. Doctors found bone cancer in his right knee, and they had to remove his leg in order to keep the cancer from moving to other parts of his body. Fox was only 18 years old.

While Fox was in the hospital, he met many other cancer patients. He saw that they were suffering very much, so he wanted to do something to help them. When Fox received a metal leg from the hospital, he decided to run across Canada with his new leg to raise money for cancer research. Fox told the Canadian Cancer Society what he hoped to do, and they supported his run, which was named the Marathon of Hope.

After training for over a year, Fox began his run on April 12, 1980, on the eastern coast of Canada. As Fox ran west and gained more attention, more and more money was given to his run. On September 1, 1980, after running for 143 days and 5,373 kilometers, Fox felt a pain in his chest and had to quit. He went to the hospital, and the doctors found that his cancer had moved to his lungs. Fox died on June 28, 1981. He had run about halfway across Canada.

Although Fox died before he could reach his goal of running all the way across Canada, he was able to give hope to cancer patients all around the world. Fox's story became famous, and a race called the Terry Fox Run has been held every year since 1981. Today, over 30 countries worldwide hold their own Terry Fox Run, and over \$600 million has been raised for cancer research.

(42)

What happened when Terry Fox was 18?

- 1 His P.E. teacher had to take him to the hospital.
- 2 His bone cancer spread to other parts of his body.
- 3 Doctors found that he had cancer in his knee.
- 4 He hurt his leg while playing sports at school.

(43)

Why did Fox decide to run across Canada?

- 1 He wanted to meet patients in different hospitals.
- 2 He wanted to help other patients like himself.
- 3 He needed to buy a leg made of metal.
- 4 He needed to pay for his medicine.

(44)

In September of 1980, Fox

- 1 died in the hospital because his lungs stopped working.
- 2 decided to run again on the west coast of Canada.
- 3 received a large amount of money from some doctors.
- 4 had to quit running because his chest began to hurt.

(45)

What is true about the Terry Fox Run?

- 1 All of the runners have had cancer at some time.
- 2 People quit running in it in 1981 after Fox died.
- 3 It is held in many countries around the world.
- 4 Its goal is to raise \$600 million for cancer research.

Living with Lions

In Kenya, the number of lions has gone from 10,000 to 2,000 in only the last 10 years. One reason for this is that farmers are killing the lions. They do this to protect their cows, sheep, and other farm animals. The Kenyan government wants to help both the farmers and the lions. However, most of the ideas for solving this problem are (**36**). Since Kenya is not a rich country, it cannot use such solutions. However, Richard Turere, a Kenyan boy, had an idea that was both useful and cheap.

Richard began to take care of his family's cows when he was just 9 years old. It was his job to watch them. However, every month, lions would eat some of them, especially at night when no one was around. When Richard was 11 years old, he thought of an idea. He knew that the lions would not (**37**) if they thought someone was nearby. Richard put small light bulbs on the fence around his family's land to stop the lions from killing the cows. He got the light bulbs from broken flashlights, and he used a solar-powered battery for electricity.

The system has been very successful, and the lions have stopped killing Richard's animals. Also, it does not cost very much—only about \$10. The idea is now (**38**). People all over Kenya have heard about it, and many have asked Richard to help them, too. The Brookhouse International School in Nairobi has even decided to let him go there for free. Now, Richard has the chance to become an engineer.

- | | | | | |
|------|-----------|-------------|--------------|-------------|
| (36) | 1 natural | 2 dangerous | 3 convenient | 4 expensive |
| (37) | 1 attack | 2 fail | 3 sleep | 4 hide |
| (38) | 1 clever | 2 old | 3 strange | 4 famous |

The Price of Success

One problem for schools is that many students do not want to study hard. As a result, they perform poorly in their classes. This is especially true in the United States, where average scores for math and science are lower than in many other countries. In recent years, schools and charities have been looking for ways to help students get better grades in these subjects. In 2008, an organization called the LMD Foundation introduced a program called Learn and Earn.

In the program, money was used to get a group of students to study harder in math and science. In addition to the normal school day, they went to after-school classes for four hours each week. The students were paid eight dollars for each hour of after-school class. By the end of the year, the students in the program had higher grades than a similar group of students who had not taken part.

Not everyone thinks that this is a good idea, though. TV reporter John Tulenko studied data from a similar program. He found that students' grades went back down when they stopped getting paid. Many people are worried about this. They think that the students study because they want money, not because they enjoy learning. Also, some people believe that these types of programs are a bad idea because it is a large part of a teacher's job to get students to study. If students are given money, some teachers might stop trying to do this.

However, others believe that these learning programs can be helpful for students from poor families. Many of these students do part-time jobs after school, and some even quit school at a young age to work. Some do this to help get money for their families. Others feel that they can learn more by working than by going to school. Programs like Learn and Earn let these students stay in school and still make money.

(42)

What is true about many students in the United States?

- 1 They are not allowed to receive help from organizations.
- 2 They study more than students in other countries.
- 3 They are doing poorly in math and science.
- 4 They do not help their classmates get better grades.

(43)

Students in the Learn and Earn program

- 1 were asked to help other students with poor grades.
- 2 were given money if their grades went up.
- 3 were made to go to school during summer vacation.
- 4 were paid to go to extra classes after school.

(44)

Why do some people think that programs like Learn and Earn are a bad idea?

- 1 Students' grades only improve a little during the program.
- 2 Students stop studying when they are in the program.
- 3 Teachers might stop trying to do a big part of their job.
- 4 Teachers have started giving low grades to save money.

(45)

It is thought that programs like Learn and Earn can have a good effect because

- 1 they allow poor students to stay in school.
- 2 they help students find jobs after graduation.
- 3 families in them can spend more time together.
- 4 students in them can go to work instead of school.

Working Together

Most people who own cars only use them for a few hours each day. This means that many cars, which cost a lot of money, are not being used for most of the day. Now, some people have thought of a new idea for a business that uses these cars. They have (**36**) private car-sharing services. These new companies provide an important service to people who do not own cars.

For a long time, people have been helping their friends and co-workers who do not own cars by driving them to work or school. However, the new car-sharing companies are changing this. Car owners sign up on a car-sharing company's website. They write the times that their car is available and how much it costs per hour. People who want to borrow a car can look for one on the company's website. They try to find a car near them that is not being used. If they find one, they can (**37**) it. After using the car, they return it to the owner.

At first, some car owners were worried about sharing their cars with other people. However, the car-sharing companies came up with ways to make the services (**38**). For instance, they check the driving history of borrowers. The companies also ask the owners to write comments about the borrowers. That way, other owners can know whether the borrowers are good drivers or not. Because of these changes, more people are using car-sharing services.

- | | | | | |
|------|--------------|----------|-----------------|----------------|
| (36) | 1 researched | 2 chosen | 3 left | 4 started |
| (37) | 1 fix | 2 rent | 3 visit | 4 clean |
| (38) | 1 safer | 2 harder | 3 more exciting | 4 more similar |

School of the Air

Australia is a huge country, and some families in the central part of the country live hundreds of kilometers from other people. In this area, known as the outback, people are far away from services like hospitals and schools. For many years, children from these areas had to live at schools far from their families or do lessons by mail.

However, in the 1940s, everything changed. A woman named Adelaide Miethke had the idea to create a school that broadcasts lessons over a radio network to children in the Australian outback. It was called the School of the Air (SOA). The SOA became very successful at connecting students and teachers, and its schools quickly covered most of Australia. There are now 16 schools giving an education to children who live too far away to attend regular schools.

Nowadays, the students of the SOA do not use radios to take classes. Instead, they use a satellite network to connect with their teachers by computer. Therefore, teachers can now use computers, web cameras, and electronic whiteboards to teach their students. These things help teachers to explain lessons more clearly, and students can have online discussions with their classmates. Although students live far away from any school, they can take part in normal classroom activities.

Darryl Cooper, an SOA teacher, has a 45-minute class with each group of his students every day. Students also have to do worksheets at home. Along with math, reading, and science classes, students can take part in violin groups and cooking classes through their computers. In addition, students take trips every year to the SOA campus, so they can have fun being with their classmates. Thanks to the SOA, these children have the chance to enjoy being part of a community of children while still living at home with their families.

(42) What is one problem children had in the Australian outback?

- 1** There were no schools near their homes.
 - 2** There was no way for them to meet their families.
 - 3** It was difficult for them to find time to study.
 - 4** It was hard for mail to be delivered to them.
-

(43) The School of the Air

- 1** teaches the history of Australian radio.
 - 2** helps students learn how to fly planes.
 - 3** asks students to buy a new computer every year.
 - 4** broadcasts lessons to students living in the outback.
-

(44) What is one way today's SOA is different from the SOA in the past?

- 1** Students learn how to make movies in their classes.
 - 2** Technology has made lessons easier to understand.
 - 3** Teachers connect with students through a radio.
 - 4** The SOA tells students to do homework on whiteboards.
-

(45) What is one way the SOA students are able to be part of a community of children?

- 1** They can play outside with their SOA friends after school.
- 2** They take math and science classes at their local school.
- 3** They enjoy time with their classmates at the SOA campus every year.
- 4** They go to violin groups and cooking classes with their classmates.

Oh, Christmas Tree

An evergreen tree is a tree that has green leaves all year round. Evergreen trees are famous for being used as Christmas trees. Although we often see Christmas trees in houses and stores in December, not many people know their history. When people see ordinary trees without leaves in the winter, they often feel sad because the trees and other plants seem dead. Evergreen trees, though, always look (**36**). So, for thousands of years, people have decorated their homes with a piece of an evergreen tree in winter. Seeing the tree helped them remember that winter would end and all the plants would become green again.

In the 16th century, Germans started to bring whole trees into their homes at Christmastime. (**37**), they just decorated the tree with candles. Later, they began to add other things, such as stars, fruit, and colored paper. Then, when German people moved to countries such as the United States in the 19th century, they took the tradition of the Christmas tree with them. Now, it has become an important part of Christmas around the world.

Because Christmas trees are very popular, thousands of evergreen trees are cut down every year to decorate people's homes. Some people are worried because this causes damage to the environment. Bill Ulfelder, the director of the Nature Conservancy's New York program, says that to solve this problem, each family should (**38**) a new tree every year. That way, everyone can enjoy the Christmas-tree tradition and, at the same time, be kind to the environment.

- | | | | | |
|------|-------------|-----------|------------|---------------|
| (36) | 1 tall | 2 weak | 3 alive | 4 light |
| (37) | 1 Therefore | 2 Finally | 3 At first | 4 For example |
| (38) | 1 plant | 2 sell | 3 watch | 4 kill |

Real Croissants

Croissants are a popular French food. In France, many people eat them for breakfast with coffee, while other people use them to make sandwiches. Around the world, people think that croissants are an important part of French culture and tradition. However, surprisingly, they were introduced into France only about 150 years ago.

Nobody knows exactly where and when croissants began to be baked, but people do know that croissants came to France from Austria. In 1839, an Austrian man named August Zang started a bakery in Paris. His bakery sold many baked goods from Austria. The most popular was what is now called the croissant. Seeing the popularity of Zang's croissants, many other French bakeries began to make and sell them, too.

Even now, croissants are one of the most popular items in French bakeries, but they are difficult and expensive to make. As a result, some bakeries have started to buy frozen croissants, bake them, and sell them in their shops. This is a good idea for bakeries that want to spend less time and money making croissants, but it makes some traditional French bakers angry.

The reason is that they think that those bakeries are breaking the government's rules about bread. The French government says that a bakery must make all of its bread by hand inside the bakery. Based on this rule, bakeries should not be allowed to sell frozen croissants made in factories. However, according to the government, croissants are not actually a bread, but a pastry like pies and tarts. Because of this, they do not have to be made in the bakery that sells them. Whether they are pastries or not, they are still a popular food.

(42)

Although croissants are a popular French food,

- 1 they do not taste good when eaten with coffee.
- 2 they were not first made in France.
- 3 people around the world think that they are not French.
- 4 people from France do not want other people to eat them.

(43)

An Austrian man named August Zang

- 1 tried to discover the history of French foods.
- 2 sold many French foods at his bakery in Austria.
- 3 thought that croissants would not be a popular food.
- 4 began to sell croissants at his bakery in Paris.

(44)

Why have some bakeries started to use frozen croissants?

- 1 They think that frozen croissants are more delicious.
- 2 They think that customers want to buy frozen croissants.
- 3 They want to save time and money when making croissants.
- 4 They want to sell their croissants to traditional bakeries.

(45)

Why can bakeries sell frozen croissants?

- 1 The rules for croissants and the rules for bread are different.
- 2 The factories where they are made are cleaner than bakeries.
- 3 French people got angry when bakeries stopped selling them.
- 4 French bakers think that frozen croissants are safer and healthier.

Front Yard Debate

Julie Bass is an American woman who lives in Oak Park, Michigan. She wanted to feed her children healthy vegetables that were grown safely, but such vegetables are usually very expensive to buy. So, in 2011, she decided to grow vegetables in her front yard, where she had some extra space. She thought this would (33) to get healthy food for her children. Bass and her children enjoyed growing vegetables together, and the people living near her thought this was a good idea.

However, not everybody was happy with Bass's new yard. The city of Oak Park sent Bass a letter telling her that she (34) vegetables in her front yard. It said that Oak Park had a law that only plants like grass and flowers could be grown in the front yard. This is because many Americans believe that yards which are covered in green grass are beautiful and make houses in the area more valuable.

When Bass did not get rid of her vegetable garden, the city told her that she might be arrested. This story was reported on the news, and many people (35). They started writing letters to the city because they thought that vegetables were actually more useful than grass. In the end, so many people complained that the city let Bass keep her garden, but people continue to talk about this around the United States.

- | | | |
|------|---|---|
| (33) | 1 be a cheaper way
3 tell other people | 2 make it difficult
4 help her neighbors |
| (34) | 1 could not eat
3 must take better care of | 2 should start to sell
4 was not allowed to grow |
| (35) | 1 got angry 2 forgot it | 3 felt bored 4 enjoyed it |

One for All

Zambia is a country in southern Africa. More than half of the population is very poor, and companies pay people very little money for their work. One woman named Sylvia Banda had a dream to become a successful businesswoman and build her own brand. So, after finishing high school, Banda went to college to learn how to start a food company. She studied hard and spent her free time coming up with ways to make money, including making food and selling it to friends.

In 1987, when Banda was 24 years old, she decided to start her own restaurant. She borrowed a room and used food, pots, and pans from her own kitchen. The first day, her restaurant did not have any chairs or tables, but she was able to sell all of the food that she had made. After counting the money, she was surprised that she had made more in one day than most people make in one month.

From that small restaurant, Banda built a large company called the Sylva Group. It now has hundreds of people working for it and is worth over a million dollars. In addition to restaurants, the company has now built hotels and a college in Zambia, and it also sells a variety of packaged foods. After reaching her goal of starting her own business and becoming rich, Banda decided to work to improve the lives of other Zambians.

She does this in a number of ways. For one, her restaurants use vegetables and other products made in Zambia, and by doing so, Banda can support local farmers. Her college also teaches farmers ways to make their farms better, which helps them make more money. The college also helps young Zambians gain skills to start their own businesses. Through hard work, Banda has been able to improve both her life and her country.

(39)

Why did Sylvia Banda go to college?

- 1 To learn how to teach at a high school.
- 2 To reach her dream of becoming a businesswoman.
- 3 Because her parents wanted her to study hard.
- 4 Because she wanted to spend time with her friends.

(40)

In 1987, Banda

- 1 worked at a small restaurant to learn how to cook.
- 2 rented rooms to her friends to make extra money.
- 3 borrowed money from a bank to start her own company.
- 4 used things from her own kitchen to start her first restaurant.

(41)

The Sylva Group

- 1 is the name of a small restaurant in Zambia.
- 2 has become a valuable company that has many workers.
- 3 builds hotels and restaurants outside of Zambia.
- 4 pays for its workers to go to college.

(42)

What is one way that Banda helps Zambian farmers?

- 1 She helps them get jobs that pay more money than farming.
- 2 She sells their vegetables at her stores for a high price.
- 3 She buys and uses their products in her restaurants.
- 4 She gives them money to make their farms better.

Racing as Equals

Dog sledding is one of the toughest sports in the world. A driver stands on a sled* and guides a team of dogs that pulls the sled through the snow. Both the driver and the dogs must be very strong in order to compete. The most famous race is a 1,600-kilometer dog-sledding race in Alaska. In the past, most teams took nearly a month to finish. However, in recent years, teams have (33). In fact, nowadays, the winners usually complete the race in just eight or nine days.

Dog sledding has traditionally been a men's sport. However, it is now becoming (34). In 1974, only one woman completed the race. By 2015, though, about one-third of the drivers were women. Some people believe that more women are taking part because they have seen other women win the race. In 1985, Libby Riddles became the first woman to win, and Susan Butcher won four times between 1986 and 1990.

In fact, dog sledding is one of the few sports where women and men compete together. Interestingly, (35) most of these sports. For example, horse riding is another sport where males and females compete together. Men and women also compete against each other in fishing tournaments. Some people believe that men and women should take part in more sports together in the future.

*sled: そり

- | | | |
|------|--|--|
| (33) | 1 been getting tired
3 become faster | 2 been getting bigger
4 won more |
| (34) | 1 easier for men
3 more dangerous with boys | 2 cheaper for girls
4 more popular with women |
| (35) | 1 animals are a part of
3 water is used in | 2 uniforms are worn in
4 snow is needed for |

Songlines

Nowadays, when people are traveling long distances, they usually follow maps and signs to get to where they are going. Thousands of years ago in Australia, however, there were no maps or signs, but people still traveled long distances without getting lost. Aboriginal people had a special way to help them travel. They used songs to describe the mountains, rivers, and rocks that people would see while they were traveling. By following the directions in these songs, called songlines, people could travel without getting lost.

Aboriginal people believe that songlines tell the story of the beginning of the world. They believe that before people lived on the earth, there were gods that lived here. The mountains, rivers, and valleys were created by these gods. For example, the Rainbow Serpent song tells the story of a snake god who created rivers and mountains while traveling around northern Australia. Aboriginal people sang this song and followed the same path.

There are songlines that describe almost every part of Australia, and they are sung in many different Aboriginal languages. However, even if people do not understand the language in the song, they can follow its directions. This is because both the words and the music help people to imagine what the land looks like. For example, a high sound means that something tall like a mountain is being described.

Songlines were an important part of Aboriginal culture for thousands of years, but this began to change when the British arrived in Australia in 1788. Aboriginal children had to go to British schools instead of spending time in nature and learning songlines from their families. Slowly, people began to forget the songlines. However, these days, the Australian government is working hard to save the songlines.

(39)

Thousands of years ago, people in Australia

- 1 had trouble learning how to read road signs.
- 2 got lost when they were trying to find places.
- 3 did not have maps or signs to follow when they traveled.
- 4 did not travel because there were too many mountains.

(40)

The Rainbow Serpent song

- 1 tells the story of how snakes were first created.
- 2 shows Aboriginal people which path to follow.
- 3 teaches people that they should take care of nature.
- 4 is sung by Aboriginal people to forget their problems.

(41)

Why can people understand songlines that are sung in different languages?

- 1 They can ask other people to explain the directions in the song.
- 2 Most Aboriginal people can speak many different languages.
- 3 The songs are easy to learn because there are not many words.
- 4 Not only the words but also the sounds describe the land.

(42)

What is one thing that changed when the British arrived in Australia?

- 1 Aboriginal families spent more time singing songlines together.
- 2 Aboriginal children began to spend less time learning their culture.
- 3 British children began to study about Aboriginal culture in school.
- 4 British families taught their children songlines to keep them safe.

Hospital Clowns

Clowns are people who dress in funny clothes and often paint their faces white and put on red noses. They tell jokes or do funny things to make people laugh. This is why many hospitals use clowns to (33) young patients. Clowns are often hired to perform for sick children, and clown faces are often painted on the walls of children's hospital rooms.

In a recent British survey, 250 hospital patients aged between 4 and 16 were interviewed about their experiences in hospitals. It found that while few children were afraid of being in the hospital, most children (34) in their rooms. In fact, some were even scared of the pictures of clowns on the walls. Although children like colorful rooms, it seems that hospital planners should start using different designs.

Tony Eldridge, a clown leader, believes that clowns do not have to be scary. He says that it is the clown's colorful makeup that probably scares children. In the past, clowns needed to use this makeup so that people could see their faces from far away in large theaters or circuses. These days, however, clowns perform in much smaller places, so they are much closer to the children. He suggests that when clowns are going to be near children, they should (35). That way, children can enjoy clowns' performances.

- | | | |
|------|--|---|
| (33) | 1 run after
3 give food to | 2 make rooms for
4 cheer up |
| (34) | 1 worried about doctors
3 disliked clowns | 2 were afraid of the dark
4 did not want parents |
| (35) | 1 wear less makeup
3 put on new clothes | 2 tell more jokes
4 have red noses |

The Corps of Discovery

Today, the United States is one of the largest nations in the world. When it first began, however, it covered only a small area of North America in the east near the Atlantic Ocean. In 1803, the president, Thomas Jefferson, chose a group of men to send to the West to explore. This group was called the Corps of Discovery. Their mission was to learn about the geography, the climate, the animals, and the people living there. Jefferson also hoped that they would find rivers that went across the country to help make traveling easier.

Meriwether Lewis and William Clark were the leaders of the group. Along with 40 other men, they began their journey on May 14, 1804. Traveling west by boat, by horse, and on foot, they took careful notes of everything that they saw. However, they had trouble communicating with the Native American people that they met. In one village, though, they met a Native American woman named Sacagawea who could translate for them.

Sacagawea spoke a few languages and knew the area well, so Lewis and Clark asked her to join the group. In addition to translating for them, Sacagawea helped them in many ways. She showed them the easiest places to travel, taught them safe places to stay, and most importantly, helped them communicate peacefully with the native people. Thanks to her, the group safely reached the Pacific Ocean.

Although the group was unable to find rivers that connected the Atlantic and Pacific Oceans, their trip was successful. They drew the first maps of the area and discovered many plants and animals that lived in the West. This information was useful for the United States and helped people start new lives in the West. The Corps of Discovery and Sacagawea are an important part of early American history.

(39)

In 1803, the Corps of Discovery was created by

- 1 the people living in the West.
- 2 the president of the United States.
- 3 a group of people who wanted to travel to the West.
- 4 an explorer interested in the United States.

(40)

Meriwether Lewis and William Clark

- 1 had problems speaking with the native people they met.
- 2 got lost while they were trying to find a village in the West.
- 3 could not take care of the horses that they brought with them.
- 4 did not have enough boats for all the people who joined their group.

(41)

What is one way that Sacagawea helped the Corps of Discovery?

- 1 She let them stay with her Native American friends.
- 2 She asked Native Americans to translate for them.
- 3 She helped them travel to the Pacific Ocean safely.
- 4 She showed them the best places to see the Pacific Ocean.

(42)

What is one way that the Corps of Discovery was successful?

- 1 They discovered animals that could be used to help people.
- 2 They found rivers that connected the Atlantic and Pacific Oceans.
- 3 They learned about plants that could be used to make medicine.
- 4 They made maps that helped people move to the West.

Life on Land

Nowadays, there are many types of animals and plants living in the oceans and on land. Billions of years ago, though, living things could only live in the oceans. The air was filled with harmful gases, and it was impossible for animals to breathe. About 500 million years ago, plants began to grow on land. They helped to (**28**). Slowly, they took the harmful gases from the air and replaced them with oxygen. After a while, they created an environment where animals could live.

Insects, such as ants and beetles, were one of the first types of living things to live on land. An international team of scientists worked together to look at over a thousand types of insects. Using new technology, they were able to learn new facts about the history of life on Earth. (**29**), they found out that the first insects began to live on Earth about 480 million years ago. This is much earlier than scientists had first believed.

The team also learned about how insects began to fly. Their research showed that about 400 million years ago, plants began to change. They started to (**30**). Then, insects began to climb up to the top of these plants to eat. Sometimes the insects would fall from these high places. Over time, their bodies changed and this made it easier for them to jump and fall. By 350 million years ago, some insects had even developed wings so they could fly.

-
- | | | |
|------|---|---|
| (28) | 1 make more water
3 add dangerous gases | 2 clean the air
4 stop the animals |
| (29) | 1 Instead 2 However 3 Even then 4 For example | |
| (30) | 1 grow taller 2 grow brown 3 get food 4 get older | |

A Popular Ride

In the late 19th century, events called world's fairs were held in many different cities. People from all around the world gathered at these fairs to introduce inventions or technologies that had just been developed. Many things were first introduced at world's fairs. For instance, the telephone was introduced at the 1876 World's Fair in Philadelphia, in the United States. Also, the Eiffel Tower, which was built for the 1889 World's Fair in Paris, became famous all over the world.

After Paris, the next world's fair was held in Chicago in 1893. The planners wanted to build something that was as great as the Eiffel Tower. A man named George Ferris designed a giant wheel that carried people high above the ground so that they could see all around them. He called it a Ferris wheel.* This first Ferris wheel was 80 meters tall, had 36 cars, and over 2,100 people could ride it at one time. During the world's fair, it was ridden by over 1.5 million people.

However, the ride caused a number of problems for Ferris. First, the giant wheel was very expensive to build. Even though many people rode it, Ferris made very little money. Then, after the fair was over, Ferris had to take apart the huge wheel and remove it. Because of its size, this was a very expensive project. As a result, when Ferris died in 1896, he was very poor.

Even though Ferris's life did not end well, people continued to use his design to build modern Ferris wheels. However, they have learned from his mistakes. Some people design smaller Ferris wheels that are easy to move from one park to another for local festivals. Other Ferris wheels, like the 135-meter-tall London Eye, are kept in one place. Whatever size they are, Ferris wheels are enjoyed by people around the world.

*Ferris wheel: 観覧車

(34)

World's fairs were events where

- 1 people could learn how to use the telephone.
- 2 people could learn about the cultures of many countries.
- 3 the newest inventions and technologies were shown to the world.
- 4 the best buildings in the world were planned and designed.

(35)

Why was the first Ferris wheel built in Chicago?

- 1 The city believed that at least 1.5 million people would visit it.
- 2 The planners wanted something special for their world's fair.
- 3 George Ferris wanted to build a large car that could carry many people.
- 4 Many people thought it would be more fun than the Eiffel Tower.

(36)

Why was George Ferris poor when he died?

- 1 He had trouble finding people to buy the wheel that he made.
- 2 It cost him too much money to make and remove his wheel.
- 3 Not many people wanted to ride his wheel.
- 4 His wheel was broken and he could not fix it.

(37)

Some modern Ferris wheels

- 1 are made so that they can be easily taken from one place to another.
- 2 are small enough to be kept in the same place all the time.
- 3 have special games so that people can enjoy the ride more.
- 4 have so many problems that they are dangerous to use at festivals.

Lake Eyre

In the desert of central Australia, there is a special lake called Lake Eyre. When large amounts of rain fall in northern Australia, the water flows through the rivers and fills the lake. However, this only happens once every eight years. After the rain stops, the lake gets smaller and smaller. After a while, the lake becomes (28). With no water, all that is left is a huge area of salt.

When there is no water, few people visit, and there are hardly any animals around. However, once the rain falls again, the scenery changes. (29) come to the area. For example, fish travel along the rivers and begin to live in the lake. Birds fly from all over Australia to lay their eggs. Scientists found more than 500,000 birds in the area in 1990. In addition, shrimp and insects come to life when the water returns.

However, some people are worried that this special lake may disappear forever. Companies now use water from the rivers around the lake. They use it for farming and other businesses. If they use too much, there may not be any water left to make Lake Eyre. Now, groups are trying to (30). Some environmental groups have bought land near the lake so that other people cannot use the water, and the Australian government has made the lake a national park. Hopefully with these efforts, Lake Eyre will continue to exist for years to come.

- | | | |
|------|---|--|
| (28) | 1 less salty
3 bigger again | 2 a little crowded
4 completely dry |
| (29) | 1 Many different animals
3 Some kinds of birds | 2 Foreign fishermen
4 Australian scientists |
| (30) | 1 clean up the lake
3 protect the lake | 2 find new uses for the water
4 get water from the government |

A Children's Toy

Many people dream of becoming rich by selling a new product. However, it is often difficult to start and run a new business. Even with good ideas and hard work, many products and businesses fail. One company that failed many times before it became a success was Kutol—the maker of a popular children's toy called Play-Doh.*

It started in 1933, when Kutol began having trouble selling its soap. Cleo McVicker, Kutol's president, needed to find a new way to make money. He heard that the heaters that people used in their homes made their walls dirty. Therefore, many people needed wallpaper cleaner to wipe their walls clean. Cleo's brother, Noah McVicker, found a way to make wallpaper cleaner. The company started selling the wallpaper cleaner to grocery stores. With its new product, Kutol began making money again.

However, in the 1950s, people began using new types of heaters that did not make the walls dirty. As a result, people stopped buying wallpaper cleaner, and Kutol was in trouble again. Luckily, the new president, Joe McVicker, heard that the wallpaper cleaner had a different use. Some teachers used it in their art classes because it was easy and fun for children to play with. Kutol added some colors to its wallpaper cleaner and started to sell it as a children's toy, Play-Doh.

At first, Kutol sold Play-Doh to schools and department stores in the United States. Then, in 1957, a character on a popular children's TV show began to play with Play-Doh. As a result, it became very popular in the United States and Europe. In 1965, Kutol sold Play-Doh to a large American toy company, and today, over 95 million cans of Play-Doh are sold every year. The story of Play-Doh shows that people should not give up when they have a problem. Instead, they must keep trying.

*Play-Doh: 子ども用工作粘土^{ねんど}の商品名

(34)

The company called Kutol

- 1 teaches children how to start a successful business by themselves.
- 2 is an example of a company that took a long time to be successful.
- 3 made toys that were difficult for children to use.
- 4 failed because it had trouble making a popular product.

(35)

What problem did Kutol have in 1933?

- 1 It was not selling enough of its product to make money.
- 2 It could not keep the wallpaper in its offices clean.
- 3 The heaters at its offices were not working.
- 4 Its new product was not very popular.

(36)

How did Joe McVicker get the idea for Play-Doh?

- 1 He wanted to find a way to recycle some old wallpaper.
- 2 He needed something new to use when teaching art to children.
- 3 He heard that his company's product was being used in children's art classes.
- 4 He saw the colorful wallpaper cleaner that was being made by another company.

(37)

How did Play-Doh become popular in the United States and Europe?

- 1 It was made by a large toy company in the United States.
- 2 It was used on a famous television program for children.
- 3 Children could make many cute characters with it.
- 4 Children began to see it in the department stores that they visited.

Challenges for Children

Many people have memories of playing in playgrounds at parks. Some children like climbing on jungle gyms while others like the slides or swings. However, from the 1990s, more and more people began to think that playgrounds were too dangerous. As a result, many cities in the United States began to (**28**). In these new playgrounds, the climbing bars were lower, and the ground was softer. As a result, there were fewer chances for children to get hurt.

Even so, some people do not think that such changes are good for children. Ellen Sandseter, a professor at Queen Maud University College in Norway, says that playgrounds help children to grow. For example, when children try to climb to a high place, they often feel afraid. However, they keep trying to climb to high places. As a result, (**29**), they start to feel less scared. This shows that when children try difficult things by themselves again and again, they can learn not to be afraid. Sandseter believes that modern playgrounds do not have enough challenges.

This causes a problem for parents. They want their children to face challenges and learn new things, but they also do not want their children to get hurt. Hoping to solve this problem, local governments in the United States have started (**30**) for playgrounds. They hope to build playgrounds that will provide exciting and fun challenges for children in a safe environment.

- | | | |
|------|------------------------------------|--------------------------------------|
| (28) | 1 change the swings | 2 stop building climbing bars |
| | 3 build safer playgrounds | 4 close their parks |
| (29) | 1 after many times | 2 with their parents' help |
| | 3 in a safe place | 4 when they are careful |
| (30) | 1 giving people money | 2 asking children to pay |
| | 3 making different problems | 4 looking at new designs |

The Recycled Orchestra

In wealthy countries like the United States and Japan, recycling is a popular way to protect the environment. However, in many poorer countries, recycling is an important way for people to make money. Adults and children look through garbage to find metal and other valuable things to sell. In this way, they can make just enough money to pay for food and housing. In South America, there are towns where many of the people make their money by doing this. One such place is Cateura, Paraguay.

Life in Cateura is sometimes difficult. Families have little money, and most children have to quit school and start working when they are still young. However, a man named Favio Chavez has been trying to make their lives better. Chavez moved to Cateura in 2006 and soon started to offer music lessons to children in the area. These lessons became very popular, but he did not have enough musical instruments for all of them to practice with.

Chavez decided to work with local people to make new musical instruments using garbage collected in the town. First, he worked with Nicolas Gomez to create violins and guitars using old salad bowls and forks. Then, with Tito Romero, he created clarinets using bottle caps, spoons, and buttons. With hard work and care, the men were able to create instruments that sounded like the real ones.

Chavez was able to teach hundreds of children in Cateura how to play instruments. Now, many of the children play in an orchestra called the Recycled Orchestra. They have the chance to travel to different countries to give performances, and they use the money that they make to pay for school and to support their families. Thanks to the Recycled Orchestra, the children and their families now have a better future to look forward to.

(34)

Why is recycling important in many poorer countries?

- 1 It is the cheapest way to help protect the environment.
- 2 It is a way for people to make the money they need to live.
- 3 It can help keep towns there clean.
- 4 It can help stop people from making garbage.

(35)

When Favio Chavez moved to Cateura,

- 1 the town did not have a school for children.
- 2 the town did not have many families living there.
- 3 he began to teach children there to play music.
- 4 he was too busy to give music lessons anymore.

(36)

How did Chavez get musical instruments?

- 1 He used the money that he received from parents to buy new ones.
- 2 He sold things that he did not need to get money to buy them.
- 3 He asked local people to give him old ones that they did not use.
- 4 He worked with local people to make them from garbage.

(37)

Children in the Recycled Orchestra

- 1 are able to travel and to help their families.
- 2 have to pay money to take part in the group.
- 3 ask their schools to help them buy musical instruments.
- 4 go to other countries to teach other children to play music.